

MATH 8803: Representation Theory II

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Contents

1	Jan. 12 — Introduction and Review	4
1.1	Review and Overview	4
1.2	Representations of Semisimple Lie Algebras	5
1.3	Representations of SL_n and GL_n	5
2	Jan. 14 — Applications of Schur-Weyl Duality	7
2.1	The Schur Functor	7
2.2	Invariant Theory	8
2.3	Weyl Character Formula for GL_n	9
2.4	Howe Duality	10
3	Jan. 21 — Minuscule Weights	11
3.1	Minuscule Weights	11
3.2	Applications of Minuscule Weights	12
4	Jan. 26 — Other Classical Lie Algebras	14
4.1	Applications of Minuscule Weights, Continued	14
4.2	Other Classical Lie Algebras	15
4.3	Representations of Symplectic Lie Algebras	15
4.4	Representations of Orthogonal Lie Algebras	16
5	Jan. 28 — Other Classical Lie Algebras, Part 2	17
5.1	More on Orthogonal Lie Algebras	17
5.2	Clifford Algebras	18
6	Feb. 2 — Duals, Maximal Weights, Exponents	20
6.1	Dual Representations	20
6.2	Maximal Weights	20
6.3	Principal $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ -Subalgebra and Exponents	21
6.4	Complex, Real, and Quaternionic Types	21
6.5	Review of Compact Lie Groups	22
7	Feb. 4 — Compact Groups	23
7.1	More on Exponents	23
7.2	Matrix Coefficients	23
7.3	Peter-Weyl Theorem	24
7.4	Introduction to Quantum Mechanics	25
8	Feb. 9 — Hydrogen Atom	26
8.1	Bound States of the Hydrogen Atom	26

8.2	Spin	28
8.3	Pauli Exclusion Principle	28
9	Feb. 11 — Real Forms	30
9.1	Automorphisms of Semisimple Lie Algebras	30
9.2	Real Forms of Semisimple Lie Algebras	30
10	Feb. 16 — Real Forms, Part 2	33
10.1	Compact Real Forms	33
10.2	Classification of Real Forms	34
11	Feb. 18 — Real Forms, Part 3	36
11.1	Classification of Real Forms, Continued	36
11.2	Real Forms of Classical Lie Algebras	37
11.3	More on Compact Groups	38
12	Feb. 23 — Classifications of Lie Groups	39
12.1	Classification of Compact Lie Groups	39
12.2	Polar Decomposition	40
13	Feb. 25 — Maximal Tori	42
13.1	Classification of Reductive Lie Groups	42
13.2	Maximal Tori	42
13.3	Semisimple and Unipotent Elements	43
13.4	Cartan Decomposition	44
14	Mar. 2 — Verma Modules	45
14.1	Integral Form of Weyl Character Formula	45
14.2	More on Verma Modules	46
14.3	Maximal Roots and the Casimir Operator	47
14.4	Affine Lie Algebras	48
15	Mar. 4 — Affine Lie Algebras	49
15.1	Affine Lie Algebras, Continued	49
15.2	Generalized Cartan Matrices	50
15.3	Verma Modules and Weyl Modules	50
15.4	Integrable Representations	52
16	Mar. 9 —	53
17	Mar. 11 —	54
18	Mar. 16 — Correlation Functions	55
18.1	Correlation Functions	55
18.2	Analyticity of Correlation Functions	57
19	Mar. 18 — KZ Equations, Part 2	59
19.1	Correlation Functions, Continued	59
19.2	Trigonometric KZ Equations	60

19.3 Factorizable Systems	61
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Lecture 1

Jan. 12 — Introduction and Review

1.1 Review and Overview

Remark. Recall that we are interested in representations of Lie groups G , which is closely related to representations of Lie algebras $\mathfrak{g}$.

We are primarily interested in semisimple Lie algebras. In this case, we fix a *Cartan subalgebra* $\mathfrak{h} \subseteq \mathfrak{g}$, where $r = \dim \mathfrak{h}$ is called the *rank*. We have the Serre generators $\{h_i, e_i, f_i\}_{i=1}^r$ and relations

$$[h_i, e_j] = a_{i,j} e_j, \quad [h_i, f_j] = a_{i,j} f_j, \quad \text{ad}_{e_i}^{1-a_{i,j}} e_j = 0, \quad \text{ad}_{f_i}^{1-a_{i,j}} f_j = 0,$$

where $a_{i,j} = \langle \alpha_i^\vee, \alpha_j \rangle$ for $\alpha_i^\vee = 2\alpha_i / (\alpha_i, \alpha_i)$. Here $\{\alpha_i\} \subseteq \mathfrak{h}^*$ and we identify $\alpha_i^\vee \leftrightarrow h_i \in \mathfrak{h}$. Then

$$\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{n}_+ \oplus \mathfrak{h} \oplus \mathfrak{n}_-,$$

where $\mathfrak{n}_+$ is generated by $\{e_i\}$ and $\mathfrak{n}_-$ is generated by $\{f_i\}$. We also have

$$\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{h} \oplus \bigoplus_{\alpha \in R} \mathfrak{g}_\alpha,$$

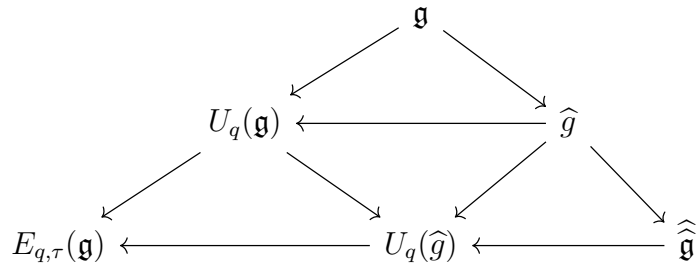
where $R = R_+ \sqcup R_-$. We have $R_+ \subseteq Q_+$ and $R_- \subseteq Q_-$, where $Q_+ = \{\sum_{i=1}^r n_i \alpha_i : n_i \geq 0\}$. If the $a_{i,j}$ are degenerate, then we can define $\widehat{\mathfrak{g}} = \mathfrak{g}[t, t^{-1}] \oplus \mathbb{C}c \oplus \mathbb{C}d$, where $\mathbb{C}c$ is called the *central extension* and $d = t \frac{d}{dt}$. We can think of these as maps $S^1 \rightarrow \mathfrak{g}$.

We can also consider the universal enveloping algebra $U(\mathfrak{g})$, and the related object. $U_q(\mathfrak{g})$ We have an R -matrix $R_{V,W}$ for the representations $V \otimes W$ and $W \otimes V$, and we have the relation

$$R_{1,2} R_{1,3} R_{2,3} = R_{2,3} R_{1,3} R_{1,2}$$

in $V_1 \otimes V_2 \otimes V_3$. A main goal later in the course will be to relate the representations of $U_q(\mathfrak{g})$ and $\widehat{\mathfrak{g}}$.

In this case, we have the diagram:



The object $U_q(\widehat{\mathfrak{g}})$ is related to quantum integrable models of spin chain type (XXX and XXZ), and $E_{q,\tau}(\mathfrak{g})$ is the *elliptic quantum group* (XYZ).

1.2 Representations of Semisimple Lie Algebras

Remark. Recall the *Weyl group* $W = \{s_\alpha(\lambda) = \lambda - \langle \lambda, \alpha^\vee \rangle \alpha\}$. The *weight lattice* is

$$P = \{\lambda \in E : \langle \lambda, \alpha^\vee \rangle \in \mathbb{Z}, \alpha \in R\} = \bigoplus_i \mathbb{Z}\omega_i,$$

where ω_i are the fundamental weights satisfying $\langle \omega_i, \alpha_j^\vee \rangle = \delta_{i,j}$.

We can consider the *highest weight representation*. The *Verma module* is $M_\lambda = U(\mathfrak{g}) \otimes_{U(\mathfrak{h} \oplus \mathfrak{n}_+)} \mathbb{C}_\lambda$, where $\mathbb{C}_\lambda$ is the 1-dimensional representation of $U(\mathfrak{h} \oplus \mathfrak{n}_+)$ on which $\mathfrak{h}$ acts by $\lambda(h)$. Then

$$P(M_\lambda) = \lambda - \mathbb{Q}_+,$$

and for each $\lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*$, M_λ has a unique irreducible quotient L_λ . The *dominant integral weights* λ satisfy

$$\langle \lambda, \alpha_i^\vee \rangle \in \mathbb{Z}_+, \quad 1 \leq i \leq r,$$

where $\lambda = \sum_{i=1}^r n_i \omega_i$ with $n_i \in \mathbb{Z}_+$.

Theorem 1.1. *The finite-dimensional irreps of $\mathfrak{g}$ are classified up to isomorphism by $\lambda \in P_+$. Moreover, $P(V)$ is Weyl invariant, and for any $\mu \in P(V)$, $w \in W$,*

$$\dim L_\lambda[\mu] = \dim L_\lambda[w\mu].$$

Example 1.0.1. For $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{sl}_2$, the dominant integral weights are $n \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$, $L_n = V_n$, and the Weyl group W acts by reflection.

Remark (Weyl character formula). Let $\chi_V(g) = \text{tr}_V(g)$. We can represent $g \sim e^h$, where $h \in \mathfrak{h}$. Then

$$\chi_V(e^h) = \sum_{\mu \in P} (\dim V(\mu)) e^{\mu(h)}.$$

We can then formally define $\chi_V = \sum_{\mu \in P} (\dim V(\mu)) e^\mu$. The *Weyl character formula* is

$$\chi_{L_\lambda} = \frac{\sum_{w \in W} (-1)^{\ell(w)} e^{w(\lambda + \rho)}}{\Delta},$$

where $\Delta = \prod_{\alpha \in R_+} (e^{\alpha/2} - e^{-\alpha/2}) = \prod_{w \in W} (-1)^{\ell(w)} e^{w\rho}$ is the *Weyl denominator*. Here $\rho = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{\alpha \in R_+} \alpha = \sum_{i=1}^r \omega_i$. The *Weyl dimension formula* is then

$$\dim L_\lambda = \frac{\prod_{\alpha \in R_+} (\alpha, \lambda + \rho)}{\prod_{\alpha \in R_+} (\alpha, \rho)}.$$

Recall the *Casimir operator* $\sum_{i=1}^{\dim \mathfrak{g}} x_i x^i \in U(\mathfrak{g})$, which acts by the scalar $(\lambda, \lambda + 2\rho)$.

1.3 Representations of SL_n and GL_n

Proposition 1.1. *For general simple $\mathfrak{g}$, let $\lambda = \sum_{i=1}^r m_i \omega_i$ be a dominant integral weight. Let $T_\lambda = \bigotimes_i L_{\omega_i}^{\otimes m_i}$ and $v = \bigotimes_i v_{\omega_i}^{\otimes m_i}$. Let V be the subrepresentation of T_λ generated by v . Then $V \cong L_\lambda$.*

Remark. For $\mathfrak{sl}_n$, we have $\lambda = \sum_{i=1}^{n-1} m_i \omega_i$. The Cartan subalgebra is

$$\mathfrak{h} = \mathbb{C}_0^n = \{(x_1, \dots, x_n) \in \mathbb{C}^n : x_1 + \dots + x_n = 0\}.$$

We have $\alpha_i^\vee = e_i - e_{i-1}$ and $\delta_{i,j} = (\omega_i, \alpha_j^\vee) = (\omega_i, e_j - e_{j+1})$, where $\omega_i = (1, \dots, 1, 0, \dots, 0)$ with i ones. We can associate λ with the partition

$$\lambda = (m_1 + \dots + m_{n-1}, m_2 + \dots + m_{n-1}, \dots, m_{n-1}, 0) = (\lambda_1, \lambda_2, \dots, \lambda_{n-1}, 0),$$

and $\lambda_1 \geq \lambda_2 \geq \dots \geq \lambda_{n-1}$. Note that L_{ω_1} is the defining representation, where $v_{\omega_1} = (1, 0, \dots, 0)^T = v_1$, where $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$ is a basis of the defining representation. Then we have that $L_{\omega_m} = \wedge^m V$ with highest weight $v_1 \wedge \dots \wedge v_m$. Here $e_i = E_{i,i+1}$. Then we see that $L_\lambda \subseteq \bigotimes_{i=1}^{n-1} (\wedge^i V)^{\otimes m_i}$.

Remark. To move to GL_n , we can write

$$\mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C}) = (\mathbb{C}^\times \times \mathrm{SL}_n(\mathbb{C})) / \mu_n,$$

where μ_n are the roots of unity embedded by $z \mapsto (z^{-1}, zI)$. We have a covering homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{C}^\times \times \mathrm{SL}_n(\mathbb{C}) &\longrightarrow \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C}) \\ (z, A) &\longmapsto zA. \end{aligned}$$

We need to determine the holomorphic representations of $\mathbb{C}^\times$. Its Lie algebra is spanned by h such that $e^{2\pi i h} = 1$. Within a representation, h acts by an operator H such that $e^{2\pi i H} = 1$. Thus all irreducible representations of $\mathbb{C}^\times$ are of the form $\chi_N(z) = z^N$. So for $\mathbb{C}^\times \times \mathrm{SL}_n(\mathbb{C})$, we have $L_{\lambda,N} = \chi_N \otimes L_\lambda$.

Exercise 1.1. Show that if $L_{\lambda,N} = \chi_N \otimes L_\lambda$, then $N = nr + \sum_{i=1}^{n-1} \lambda_i$ for some integer r .

Remark. Letting $m_n = r \geq 0$ in the above exercise, the representation $L_{\lambda, nm_n + \sum_{i=1}^{n-1} \lambda_i}$ for $\mathfrak{gl}_n$ corresponds to the partition $(m_1 + \dots + m_n, \dots, m_{n-1} + m_n, m_n)$.

Remark. For SL_n , the representation $\wedge^n V$ is trivial, but it is the determinant for GL_n . For GL_n , we also have χ^k and $(\chi^*)^k = \chi^{-k}$, these are called the *polynomial representations*.

Remark. Let $\lambda = (\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_n)$ with $\lambda_1 \geq \dots \geq \lambda_n$ be a partition with at most n parts. Then $|\lambda| = \sum_i \lambda_i$ is an eigenvalue of $1_n = \sum_{i=1}^n e_{i,i} \in \mathfrak{gl}_n$. We can realize λ as a Young diagram. Note that L_λ occurs in $V^{\otimes N}$, where V is the defining representation. We can decompose

$$V^{\otimes N} = \bigoplus_{\lambda: |\lambda|=N} L_\lambda \otimes \pi_\lambda,$$

where $\pi_\lambda = \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})}(L_\lambda, V^{\otimes N})$. There is a natural action of S_N on $V^{\otimes N}$.

Theorem 1.2 (Schur-Weyl duality). *Let A be the image of $U(\mathfrak{gl}_n)$ in $\mathrm{End}(V^{\otimes N})$ and B be the image of $\mathbb{C}S_N$ in $\mathrm{End}(V^{\otimes N})$. Then*

1. *the centralizer of A is B and vice versa;*
2. *if λ has at most n parts, then the representation π_λ of B (and hence of S_N) is irreducible, and such representations are pairwise non-isomorphic;*
3. *if $\dim V \geq N$, then the π_λ exhaust all irreducible representations of S_N .*

Lecture 2

Jan. 14 — Applications of Schur-Weyl Duality

2.1 The Schur Functor

Remark. Let V be the defining representation for GL_n . Then

$$V^{\otimes N} = \bigoplus_{\lambda: |\lambda|=N} L_\lambda \otimes \pi_\lambda.$$

Recall that if $\lambda = (\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_n)$, then we have

$$\lambda_1 = m_1 + \dots + m_n, \quad \lambda_2 = m_2 + \dots + m_n, \quad \dots, \quad \lambda_n = m_n.$$

Definition 2.1. Suppose we are given the partition λ of N . The *Schur functor* S^λ is given by

$$S^\lambda V = \mathrm{Hom}_{S_N}(\pi_\lambda, V^{\otimes N})$$

for a vector space V . Note that this language, we have $V^{\otimes N} = \bigoplus_\lambda S^\lambda V \otimes \pi_\lambda$.

Example 2.1.1. Consider the following:

1. $S^{(n)}V = S^n V$, where (n) is the partition of n with a single part.
2. $S^{(1^n)}V = \wedge^n V$, where (1^n) is the partition of n with n parts equal to 1.
3. $V \otimes V = S^{(2)}V \otimes \mathbb{C}_+ \oplus S^{(1,1)}V \otimes \mathbb{C}_-$, where $\mathbb{C}_2$ acts trivially on $\mathbb{C}_+$ and by the sign on $\mathbb{C}_-$.
4. $V \otimes V \otimes V = S^{(3)}V \otimes \mathbb{C}_+ \oplus S^{(2,1)}V \otimes \mathbb{C}^2 \oplus S^{(1,1,1)}V \otimes \mathbb{C}_-$, where S_3 acts trivially on $\mathbb{C}_+$ and by sign on $\mathbb{C}_-$ as before, and $\mathbb{C}^2 = \{(x, y, z) : x + y + z = 0\}$.

Note that $V \otimes V = S^2 V \oplus \wedge^2 V$, so $S^2 V \otimes V = S^3 V \oplus S^{(2,1)}V$ and $\wedge^2 V \otimes V = \wedge^3 V \oplus S^{(2,1)}V$.

Remark. Let $\dim V = N$ and λ have k parts. Recall that by the Weyl dimension formula,

$$\dim L_\lambda = \frac{\prod_{\alpha \in R_+} (\alpha, \lambda + \rho)}{\prod_{\alpha \in R_+} (\alpha, \rho)}.$$

We have $R_+ = \{\alpha_{i,j} = e_i - e_j : i < j\}$ and $\rho = \sum_{i=1}^{N-1} \omega_i = (N-1, N-2, \dots, 1, 0)$ (recall that ω_i is i ones followed by zeros). Thus we see that

$$\dim S^\lambda V = \prod_{1 \leq i < j \leq N} \frac{\lambda_i - \lambda_j + j - i}{j - i} = \prod_{1 \leq i < j \leq k} \frac{\lambda_i - \lambda_j + j - i}{j - i} \prod_{1 \leq i < k < j \leq N} \frac{\lambda_i + j - i}{j - i}.$$

We can rewrite the second product as

$$\prod_{1 \leq k < j \leq N} \frac{\lambda_i + j - i}{j - i} = \prod_{i=1}^k \frac{(N+1-i) \cdots (N+\lambda_i-i)}{(k+1-i) \cdots (k+\lambda_i-i)}.$$

Proposition 2.1. *We have $\dim S^\lambda V = P_\lambda(N)$, where P_λ is a polynomial of degree $|\lambda|$ with rational coefficients and integer roots. The roots of P_λ are all integers from the interval $[1 - \lambda_1, k - 1]$ (occurring with multiplicities).*

Example 2.1.2. Let $P_n(N)$ correspond to $S^n V$. Then $\lambda_1 = n$ and $k = 1$, and

$$P_n(N) = \dim S^n V = \binom{N+n-1}{n}.$$

Similarly, one can see that

$$P_{1^n}(N) = \dim \wedge^n V = \binom{N}{n}.$$

One can also consider $P_{(a,b)}(N)$ corresponding to partitions with two parts. The values $P_{(a,n)}(N)$ are called the Narayana numbers, which are of use in combinatorics.

2.2 Invariant Theory

Remark. Let V be a finite-dimensional vector space and $\{T_i\} \in (V^*)^{\otimes m_i} \otimes V^{\otimes n_i}$ for $i = 1, \dots, k$. One would like to characterize *invariants* of such collections, i.e. polynomial functions $F(T_1, \dots, T_k)$ which are invariant under the action of $\mathrm{GL}(V)$.

One can think of such a tensor in $(V^*)^{\otimes m_i} \otimes V^{\otimes n_i}$ as a vertex with m_i incoming edges and n_i outgoing edges. Then constructing invariants $\{T_i\}$ reduces to studying graphs where T_i corresponds to a vertex v_i of the graph Γ . This allows us to assign to a given graph an invariant function F_Γ .

Theorem 2.1. *The functions F_Γ for various Γ span the space of invariant functions.*

Proof. We can view an invariant as an invariant element of the space $\bigotimes_{i=1}^k ((V^*)^{\otimes m_i} \otimes V^{\otimes n_i})$, which we can view as $\mathrm{End}_{\mathrm{GL}(n)}(V^{\otimes M}, V^{\otimes N})$, where $M = \sum d_i m_i$ (the number of incoming edges) and $N = \sum d_i n_i$ (the number of outgoing edges). Note that this space is empty when $M \neq N$, and the statement follows by Schur-Weyl duality when $M = N$. $\square$

Example 2.1.3. Let $m_i = n_i = 1$. Then $T_1, \dots, T_k$ are matrices. Then the graph Γ must look like a cycle, hence the invariants are all of the form

$$F_{j_1, \dots, j_r}(T_1, \dots, T_k) = \mathrm{tr}(T_{j_1} \cdots T_{j_r}).$$

Note that these invariants are asymptotically algebraically independent (when V is large enough). In particular, if $P(T_1, \dots, T_k) = 0$ in all dimensions, then $\mathrm{tr}(P(T_1, \dots, T_k)T_{k+1}) = 0$, which cannot be true as the trace decomposes in terms of the $F_{j_1, \dots, j_r}$. (However, note that $[X, Y] = 0$ for 1×1 matrices and $[Z, [X, Y]^2] = 0$ for 2×2 matrices.) This also implies the uniqueness of the μ_n in the BCH formula:

$$\log(\exp(x) \exp(y)) = \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{\mu_n(x, y)}{n!}.$$

2.3 Weyl Character Formula for GL_n

Remark (Weyl character formula for GL_n). Recall that Weyl's character formula gives

$$\chi_\lambda = \frac{\sum_{w \in W} (-1)^{\ell(w)} e^{w(\lambda + \rho)}}{\sum_{\alpha \in R_+} (e^{\alpha/2} - e^{-\alpha/2})}, \quad (*)$$

where the denominator is $\Delta = \prod_{\alpha \in R_+} (e^{\alpha/2} - e^{-\alpha/2}) = \prod_{w \in W} (-1)^{\ell(w)} e^{w(\rho)}$. Letting $\rho = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{\alpha \in R_+} \alpha$,

$$\Delta = e^\rho \prod_{\alpha \in R_+} (1 - e^{-\alpha}) = x_1^{n-1} x_2^{n-2} \cdots x_n^0 \prod_{i < j} (1 - x_j/x_i),$$

where $\rho = (n-1, n-2, \dots, 1, 0)$ and $x_i = e^{e_i}$ (e.g. $x_1 = e^{(1,0,\dots,0)}$). After multiplying we get that

$$\Delta = \prod_{i < j} (x_i - x_j).$$

On the other hand, using $\Delta = \prod_{w \in W} (-1)^{\ell(w)} e^{w(\rho)}$, we have

$$\Delta = \sum_{w \in W} (-1)^{\ell(w)} e^{w(\rho)} = \sum_{s \in S_n} \text{sign}(s) x_{s(1)}^{n-1} \cdots x_{s(n)}^0.$$

Comparing these two formulas, we recover the formula for the Vandermonde determinant:

$$\det(\{x_j^{n-i}\}_{1 \leq i, j \leq n}) = \sum_{s \in S_n} \text{sign}(s) x_{s(1)}^{n-1} \cdots x_{s(n)}^0 = \prod_{i < j} (x_i - x_j).$$

Now applying this to the numerator of (*), we have

$$\sum_{w \in W} (-1)^{\ell(w)} e^{w(\lambda + \rho)} = \sum_{s \in S_n} \text{sign}(s) x_{s(1)}^{\lambda_1 + n - 1} \cdots x_{s(n)}^{\lambda_n + 0}.$$

Thus in total, the character χ_λ is given by

$$\chi_\lambda = \frac{\sum_{s \in S_n} \text{sign}(s) x_{s(1)}^{\lambda_1 + n - 1} \cdots x_{s(n)}^{\lambda_n + 0}}{\prod_{i < j} (x_i - x_j)} = \frac{\det(\{x_i^{\lambda_j + n - i}\})}{\prod_{i < j} (x_i - x_j)}.$$

These functions are known as the *Schur polynomials* $s_\lambda(x_1, \dots, x_n)$.

Example 2.1.4 (Character of $S^m V$). Using the above formula, we get the identity

$$s_{(m)}(x_1, \dots, x_n) = \sum_{1 \leq j_1 \leq \dots \leq j_m \leq n} x_{j_1} \cdots x_{j_m} = h_m(x_1, \dots, x_n),$$

the m th complete symmetric function.

Example 2.1.5 (Character of $\wedge^m V$). Similarly, one gets the identity

$$s_{(1^m)}(x_1, \dots, x_n) = \sum_{1 \leq j_1 < \dots < j_m \leq n} x_{j_1} \cdots x_{j_m} = e_m(x_1, \dots, x_n),$$

the m th elementary symmetric function.

Example 2.1.6 (Trace in $V^{\otimes N}$). Consider $x \otimes \sigma$, where $x = \text{diag}(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ and σ has m_i cycles of length i . Then we have

$$\text{tr}_{V^{\otimes N}}(x \otimes \sigma) = \prod_i (x_1^i + \dots + x_n^i)^{m_i}.$$

By Schur-Weyl duality, we have that

$$\text{tr}_{V^{\otimes N}}(x \otimes \sigma) = \sum_{\lambda} \chi_{\lambda}(\sigma) s_{\lambda}(x) = \prod_i (x_1^i + \dots + x_n^i)^{m_i}.$$

Using the formula for the Schur polynomial, we get the identity

$$\sum_{\lambda} \chi_{\lambda}(\sigma) \det(\{x_i^{\lambda_j + N - j}\}) = \prod_{i < j} (x_i - x_j) \prod_i (x_1^i + \dots + x_n^i)^{m_i}.$$

Theorem 2.2 (Frobenius character formula). $\chi_{\lambda}(\sigma)$ is the coefficient of $x_1^{\lambda_1 + N - 1} \dots x_N^{\lambda_N}$ in the polynomial

$$\prod_{i < j} (x_i - x_j) \prod_i (x_1^i + \dots + x_n^i)^{m_i}.$$

2.4 Howe Duality

Remark. Fix V, W and consider $S^n(V \otimes W)$, which is a representation of $\text{GL}(V) \otimes \text{GL}(W)$.

Theorem 2.3 (Howe duality). *We have a decomposition*

$$S^n(V \otimes W) = \bigoplus_{\lambda: |\lambda|=n} S^{\lambda}V \otimes S^{\lambda}W.$$

Proof. We can write

$$S^n(V \otimes W) = ((V \otimes W)^{\otimes n})^{S_n} = (V^{\otimes n} \otimes W^{\otimes n})^{S_n}.$$

Using Schur-Weyl duality for each part, we get that

$$\begin{aligned} S^n(V \otimes W) &= \left(\left(\bigoplus_{\lambda: |\lambda|=n} S^{\lambda}V \otimes \pi_{\lambda} \right) \otimes \left(\bigoplus_{\mu: |\mu|=n} S^{\mu}W \otimes \pi_{\mu} \right) \right)^{S_n} \\ &= \bigoplus_{\lambda, \mu: |\lambda|=|\mu|=n} S^{\lambda}V \otimes S^{\mu}W \otimes (\pi_{\lambda} \otimes \pi_{\mu})^{S_n}. \end{aligned}$$

Since $\pi_{\lambda} = \pi_{\lambda}^*$, by Schur's lemma we have $(\pi_{\lambda} \otimes \pi_{\mu})^{S_n} = \mathbb{C}^{\delta_{\lambda, \mu}}$. □

Corollary 2.3.1 (Cauchy identity). *Let $x = (x_1, \dots, x_r)$ and $y = (y_1, \dots, y_s)$. Then*

$$\sum_{\lambda} s_{\lambda}(x) s_{\lambda}(y) z^{|\lambda|} = \prod_{i=1}^r \prod_{j=1}^s \frac{1}{1 - z x_i y_j}.$$

Lecture 3

Jan. 21 — Minusculous Weights

3.1 Minusculous Weights

Remark. Let $\mathfrak{g}$ be a simple complex Lie algebra.

Definition 3.1. A dominant integral weight ω for $\mathfrak{g}$ is called *minusculous* if $\langle \omega, \beta \rangle \leq 1$ for every positive coroot β (equivalently, if $|\langle \omega, \alpha \rangle| \leq 1$ for any coroot β).

Example 3.1.1. Clearly $\omega = 0$ is minusculous.

Example 3.1.2. Let $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{sl}_n$ with fundamental weights $\{\omega_i\}_{i=1}^{n-1}$,¹ where

$$\omega_i = (\underbrace{1, \dots, 1}_i, 0, \dots, 0)$$

Let $\alpha_{i,j} = \alpha_{i,j}^\vee = e_i - e_j$. Note that $\langle \omega_i, e_j - e_k \rangle = 0$ when $j, k \leq i$ or $j, k > i$, and $\langle \omega_i, e_j - e_k \rangle = 1$ when $j \leq i < k$. So all of the ω_i are minusculous in this case.

Lemma 3.1. *Every nonzero minusculous weight is fundamental.*

Proof. Suppose ω is minusculous. Then there exists i with $\langle \omega, \alpha_i^\vee \rangle = 1$. Moreover, there can only be one such i , since if there were many, then $\langle \omega, \theta^\vee \rangle \geq 2$, where $\theta^\vee$ is the longest coroot (i.e. if $\theta = \sum_{m_i > 0} m_i \alpha_i$ is the longest root, then $\theta^\vee = \sum_{m_i > 0} m_i \alpha_i^\vee$). So ω is necessarily fundamental. $\square$

Example 3.1.3. For G_2 , F_4 , and F_8 , none of the fundamental weights are minusculous.

Lemma 3.2. *A fundamental weight ω_i is minusculous if and only if $m_i = 1$ where $\theta^\vee = \sum_j m_j \alpha_j^\vee$.*

Proof. By the minusculous condition, we know $m_i \leq 1$. If $m_i = 1$, then for any positive coroot $\beta = \sum n_j \alpha_j^\vee$ we have $n_j \leq m_j$, so $n_i \leq 1$. Thus $\langle \omega_i, \beta \rangle = n_i \leq 1$, so ω_i is minusculous. $\square$

Lemma 3.3. *If $\omega \in Q$ with $|\langle \omega, \beta \rangle| \leq 1$ for all coroots β , then $\omega = 0$.*

Proof. Assume to the contrary that $\omega = \sum_i \alpha_i \neq 0$. We may assume that $\sum_i |m_i|$ is smallest possible. Then $0 < (\omega, \omega) = \sum_i m_i (\omega, \alpha_i)$, since the form is positive definite. Thus there exists j such that m_j and $\langle \omega, \alpha_j^\vee \rangle$ have the same sign. By replacing ω with $-\omega$ if necessary, we may assume both are positive. Then $\langle \omega, \alpha_j^\vee \rangle = 1$. Consider the reflection $s_j(\omega) = \omega - \alpha_j = \sum_i m'_i \alpha_i$. So $m'_i = m_j - 1$ and $m'_i = m_i$. But then $\sum_i |m'_i| = \sum_i |m_i| - 1 < \sum_i |m_i|$, contradicting the minimality of ω . $\square$

¹Recall a *fundamental weight* is a weight ω_i such that $\langle \omega_i, \alpha_j^\vee \rangle = \delta_{i,j}$ for all simple coroots $\alpha_j^\vee$.

Proposition 3.1. *The following conditions are equivalent:*

1. ω is minuscule;
2. all weights of L_ω belong to the Weyl orbit $W\omega$;
3. if λ is a dominant integral weight such that $\omega - \lambda \in Q_+$, then $\lambda = \omega$.

Proof. (1 $\Rightarrow$ 3) If $\omega = 0$, then $-\lambda \in Q_+$, so $(\lambda, \rho) \leq 0$ where $\rho = \sum_{i=1}^r \omega_i$, so $\lambda = 0$. Now let $\omega = \omega_i$ be minuscule. Then $\omega_i - \lambda = \sum_k m_k \alpha_k$ with $m_k \geq 0$. If $m_k = 0$ for $k \neq i$, then the problem reduces to a lower rank Dynkin diagram. So we can assume $m_k > 0$ for every $k \neq i$. Let β be a positive coroot, then

$$\langle \omega_i - \lambda, \beta \rangle = \langle \omega_i, \beta \rangle - \langle \lambda, \beta \rangle \leq \langle \omega_i, \beta \rangle \leq 1.$$

If $\alpha_j^\vee$ does not occur in β , then the above is ≤ 0 . In particular, we have $\langle \omega_i - \lambda, \alpha_j^\vee \rangle \leq 0$ for $j \neq i$. If we also have $\langle \omega_i - \lambda, \alpha_i^\vee \rangle \leq 0$, then $(\omega_i - \lambda, \omega_i - \lambda) \leq 0$, so $\omega_i = \lambda$. Otherwise, $\langle \omega_i - \lambda, \alpha_i^\vee \rangle = 1$. Then $m_j > 0$ for every j , so $\langle \omega_i - \lambda, \theta^\vee \rangle \geq 1$, since $\theta^\vee$ is a dominant coweight. Then $\langle \lambda, \theta^\vee \rangle \leq 0$, so we must have $\lambda = 0$ since $\theta^\vee$ contains all $\alpha_j^\vee$ with positive coefficients. But then $\omega_i \in Q$, which is impossible by Lemma 3.3.

(3 $\Rightarrow$ 2) If μ is any weight of L_ω , then there exists $w \in W$ such that $\lambda = w\mu$ is dominant (since every orbit of W intersects the dominant chamber at exactly 1 point). Then $\omega - \lambda \in Q_+$, so $\lambda = \omega$, hence $\mu = w^{-1}\omega \in W\omega$.

(2 $\Rightarrow$ 1) Suppose otherwise ω is not minuscule. Then $\langle \omega, \alpha^\vee \rangle > 1$ for some positive coroot $\alpha^\vee$. Then

$$2(\omega, \alpha) > (\alpha, \alpha).$$

Note that $\omega - \alpha$ is a weight of L_ω (weight of $f_\alpha v_\omega$, where v_ω is a highest weight vector and $\{e_\alpha, f_\alpha, \alpha^\vee\}$ is an $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ -triple). But $\omega - \alpha$ is not W -conjugate to ω , since

$$(\omega - \alpha, \omega - \alpha) = (\omega, \omega) - 2(\omega, \alpha) + (\alpha, \alpha) < (\omega, \omega)$$

but the pairing is W -invariant. Contradiction. □

Corollary 3.0.1. *If ω is minuscule, then $\chi_\omega = \sum_{\gamma \in W\omega} e^\gamma$.*

3.2 Applications of Minuscule Weights

Proposition 3.2. *$\omega \in P_+$ is minuscule if and only if the restriction of L_ω to any root $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ -subalgebra of $\mathfrak{g}$ is the direct sum of 1-dimensional and 2-dimensional representations.*

Proof. ($\Rightarrow$) Let ω be minuscule and $v \in L_\omega$ the highest weight vector (of weight $w\omega$) for $(\mathfrak{sl}_2)_\alpha$. Then

$$h_\alpha v = \langle w\omega, \alpha^\vee \rangle v = \langle \omega, w^{-1}\alpha^\vee \rangle v.$$

Then $h_\alpha v = 0$ or $h_\alpha v = v$, so the representation is 1-dimensional or 2-dimensional.

($\Leftarrow$) Suppose ω is not minuscule. Then there exists $\alpha \in Q_+$ with $\langle \omega, \alpha^\vee \rangle = m > 1$. Let v_ω be a highest weight vector, then $h_\alpha v_\omega = \langle \omega, \alpha^\vee \rangle v_\omega$, which leads to a higher-dimensional $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ -representation. □

Corollary 3.0.2. *If ω is minuscule, then for every dominant integral weight λ of $\mathfrak{g}$, we have*

$$L_\omega \otimes L_\lambda = \bigoplus_{\gamma \in W\omega} L_{\lambda+\gamma}.$$

(It is assumed that if $\lambda + \gamma$ is not dominant, then $L_{\lambda+\gamma} = 0$.)

Proof. We know $\chi_\omega = \sum_{\mu \in W\omega} e^\mu$. Then we have

$$\chi_{L_\omega \otimes L_\lambda} = \frac{\sum_{\mu \in W\omega} \sum_{w \in W} (-1)^{\ell(w)} e^{w(\lambda+\rho)+\mu}}{\Delta} = \frac{\sum_{\gamma \in W\omega} \sum_{w \in W} (-1)^{\ell(w)} e^{w(\lambda+\gamma+\rho)}}{\Delta}$$

where Δ is the Weyl denominator. If $\lambda + \gamma \notin P_+$, then for some $\alpha_i^\vee$, we get $\langle \lambda + \gamma, \alpha_i^\vee \rangle < 0$. But we know $\langle \gamma, \alpha_i^\vee \rangle \geq -1$, so $\langle \lambda + \gamma, \alpha_i^\vee \rangle = -1$. Thus $\langle \lambda + \gamma + \rho, \alpha_i^\vee \rangle = 0$, so for any $w\gamma$, the term $ws_i\gamma$ comes with the opposite sign. So we get that

$$\chi_{L_\omega \otimes L_\lambda} = \frac{\sum_{\gamma \in W\omega : \lambda+\gamma \in P_+} \sum_{w \in W} (-1)^{\ell(w)} e^{w(\lambda+\gamma+\rho)}}{\Delta} = \sum_{\gamma \in W\omega : \lambda+\gamma \in P_+} \chi_{\lambda+\gamma},$$

which proves the desired result. $\square$

Example 3.1.4. For $\mathfrak{sl}_2$, we have $L_1 \otimes L_m = L_{m+1} \oplus L_{m-1}$, which leads to the formula

$$L_m \otimes L_n = \bigoplus_{k=|m-n|}^{m+n} L_k$$

Example 3.1.5. Let $V = V_{\omega_1}$ be the defining representation for GL_n . Then

$$L_{\omega_1} \otimes L_\lambda = \bigoplus_{\mu \in \lambda + \square} L_\mu,$$

where λ is a partition and $\lambda + \square$ denotes the set of partitions obtained by adding a single box to λ . For example, for $\lambda = (3, 3, 2, 1)$ we have

$$L_{\omega_1} \otimes S^{(3,3,2,1)}V = S^{(4,3,2,1)}V \oplus S^{(3,3,3,1)}V \oplus S^{(3,3,2,2)}V \oplus S^{(3,3,2,1,1)}V.$$

Similarly, for $\wedge^m V = L_{\omega_m}$ (where $\omega_m = (1, \dots, 1, 0, \dots, 0)$ with m ones), we have

$$L_{\omega_m} \otimes L_\lambda = \bigoplus_{\mu \in \lambda + m\square} L_\mu,$$

where we are allowed to add m boxes to λ in $\lambda + m\square$. For example,

$$\wedge^2 V \otimes S^{(3,1)}V = S^{(4,2)}V \oplus S^{(4,1,1)}V \oplus S^{(3,2,1)}V \oplus S^{(3,1,1,1)}V.$$

Lecture 4

Jan. 26 — Other Classical Lie Algebras

4.1 Applications of Minuscule Weights, Continued

Proposition 4.1. *We have the following:*

1. Let λ be a partition of N . Then $\mathbb{C}S_{N+1} \otimes_{S_N} \pi_\lambda = \bigoplus_{\mu \in \lambda + \square} \pi_\mu$.
2. Let μ be a partition of $N + 1$. Then $\pi_\mu|_{S_N} = \bigoplus_{\lambda \in \mu - \square} \pi_\lambda$.

Proof. (1) Let V be a vector space of sufficiently large dimension. By Frobenius reciprocity,

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{S_{N+1}}(\mathbb{C}S_{N+1} \otimes_{S_N} \pi_\lambda, V^{\otimes(N+1)}) \cong \mathrm{Hom}_{S_N}(\pi_\lambda, V^{\otimes N} \otimes V) = V \otimes S^\lambda V.$$

Now by Schur-Weyl duality, we have

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{S_{N+1}}\left(\bigoplus_{\mu \in \lambda + \square} \pi_\mu, V^{\otimes(N+1)}\right) = \bigoplus_{\mu \in \lambda + \square} S^\mu V.$$

Since $V \otimes S^\lambda V = \bigoplus_{\mu \in \lambda + \square} S^\mu V$, we conclude that $\mathbb{C}S_{N+1} \otimes_{S_N} \pi_\lambda = \bigoplus_{\mu \in \lambda + \square} \pi_\mu$.

(2) This is left as an exercise. Use a different version of Frobenius reciprocity. $\square$

Definition 4.1. Let λ be a partition, and $\lambda^\dagger$ be the *conjugate partition* (the one corresponding to the transposed diagram). For example, $(3, 3, 2, 1)^\dagger = (4, 3, 2)$.

Corollary 4.0.1. Let $\mathbb{C}_-$ be the sign representation of S_N . Then $\pi_\lambda \otimes \mathbb{C}_- \cong \pi_{\lambda^\dagger}$.

Proof. This is left as an exercise. The proof is by induction on $N = |\lambda|$. Let $C = \sum_{i < j} (i \ j)$, and note that its eigenvalues are the same as the Casimir operator of SL_N . $\square$

Proposition 4.2 (Skew Howe duality). *We have a decomposition $\wedge^n(V \otimes W) = \bigoplus_\lambda S^\lambda V \otimes S^{\lambda^\dagger} W$ (as $\mathrm{GL}(V) \otimes \mathrm{GL}(W)$ -modules).*

Proposition 4.3. *Every coset in P/Q contains a unique minuscule weight. This gives a bijection between P/Q and minuscule weights, so the number of minuscule weights is equal to $\det A$, where A is the Cartan matrix.*

Proof. Let $C = a + Q \in P/Q$ be a coset. Let $\omega \in C \cap P_+$ be the element which minimizes $\langle \omega, \rho^\vee \rangle$. If λ is the dominant weight for L_ω , then $\lambda \in C \cap P_+$ implies that

$$(\lambda, \rho^\vee) \geq (\omega, \rho^\vee).$$

Thus $(\omega - \lambda, \rho^\vee) \leq 0$, so $\omega - \lambda \in Q_+$. Thus $\lambda = \omega$, so ω is minuscule. Now suppose $\omega_1, \omega_2 \in C$ are minuscule and $\omega_1 \neq \omega_2$ with $\omega_1 - \omega_2 \in Q$. By Lemma 3.3, we must have $\langle \omega_1 - \omega_2, \beta \rangle \geq 2$ for all coroots β . But then $\langle \omega_1, \beta \rangle = 1$ (which implies $\beta > 0$) and $\langle \omega_2, \beta \rangle = -1$ (which implies $\beta < 0$), a contradiction. $\square$

Remark. Let A be the Cartan matrix. For every root, we can write

$$\alpha_i = \sum_{j=1}^r A_{i,j} \omega_j.$$

We have a covering map $\mathbb{R}^r / \Lambda_2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^r / \Lambda_1$, where $\Lambda_2 = P$ and $\Lambda_1 = Q$. Then $\det A$ is precisely the degree of this covering, which counts the number of cosets.

4.2 Other Classical Lie Algebras

Example 4.1.1. Recall that $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{sp}_{2n}$ corresponds to the Dynkin diagram C_n ($\bullet \cdots \bullet \rightleftarrows \bullet$), where the arrow points from longer roots to shorter roots. We have $R_+ = e_i \pm e_j, 2e_j$. The simple roots are

$$\alpha_1 = e_1 - e_2, \quad \alpha_2 = e_2 - e_3, \quad \dots, \quad \alpha_{n-1} = e_{n-1} - e_n, \quad \alpha_n = 2e_n.$$

We have $\alpha_i^\vee = \alpha_i$ for $i \neq n$ and $\alpha_n^\vee = e_n$, and $\omega_i = (1, \dots, 1, 0, \dots, 0)$ (with i ones) for $1 \leq i \leq n$.

Example 4.1.2. The Dynkin diagram B_n ($\bullet \cdots \bullet \rightleftarrows \bullet$) corresponds to $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{so}_{2n+1}$. Most things are the same as above, but we will have $\alpha_n = e_n$ and $\alpha_n^\vee = 2e_n$. We have the same ω_i for $i < n$, but we get $\omega_n = (1/2, \dots, 1/2)$. We have $R_+ = e_i \pm e_j, e_i$.

Example 4.1.3. The Dynkin diagram D_n ($\bullet \cdots \bullet \begin{smallmatrix} \nearrow \\ \searrow \end{smallmatrix}$) corresponds to $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{so}_{2n}$. In this case we have $R_+ = e_i \pm e_j$, and simple roots given by

$$\alpha_1 = e_1 - e_2, \quad \dots, \quad \alpha_{n-2} = e_{n-1}, \quad \alpha_{n-1} = e_{n-1} - e_n, \quad \alpha_n = e_{n-1} + e_n.$$

We have $\omega_i = (1, \dots, 1, 0, \dots, 0)$ (with i ones) for $i = 1, \dots, n-2$, but we get $\omega_{n-1} = (1/2, \dots, 1/2, 1/2)$ and $\omega_n = (1/2, \dots, 1/2, -1/2)$.

Remark. We have the following:

- For G_2, F_4, F_8 , we have $\det A = 1$ (here A is the Cartan matrix), so the only minuscule weight is 0.
- For B_n , we have $\det A = 2$ (the nontrivial minuscule weight is $(1/2, \dots, 1/2)$, and the representation has weights $(\pm 1/2, \dots, \pm 1/2)$ with all possible combinations of $\pm$ and dimension 2^n).
- For D_n , we have $\det A = 4$. The minuscule weights are $\omega_1, \omega_{n-1}, \omega_n$. Here ω_1 is the $2n$ -dimensional defining representation. The other two are spin representations of dimension 2^{n-1} , with weights $(\pm 1/2, \dots, \pm 1/2)$, taking even or odd numbers of $-$ signs.

4.3 Representations of Symplectic Lie Algebras

Remark. For $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{sp}_{2n}$, we have the Dynkin diagram C_n and

$$\omega_i = (\underbrace{1, \dots, 1}_{i \text{ ones}}, 0, \dots, 0).$$

The elements of the Cartan subalgebra are given by $\text{diag}(a_1, \dots, a_n, -a_1, \dots, -a_n)$. So $L_{\omega_1} = V$ (the defining representation) with highest weight e_1 . Note that $\wedge^2 V$ is not irreducible:

$$\wedge^2 V = \wedge_0^2 V \oplus \mathbb{C},$$

where $\mathbb{C}$ is the trivial representation spanned by $B^{-1} = \sum_i e_{i+n} \wedge e_i$ (note that B^{-1} is invariant under $\mathfrak{sp}_{2n}$). However, one can check that $\wedge_0^2 V$ is irreducible.

Now let us consider L_{ω_j} for $j \geq 2$. Let $B = \sum_i e_i^* \wedge e_{i+n}^*$. We have an operator

$$i_B : \wedge^{i+1} V \longrightarrow \wedge^{i-1} V,$$

and we can denote $\wedge_0^i V = \ker(i_B|_{\wedge^i V})$ (note that $i_B|_{\wedge^i V}$ is injective when $i \geq n$). The $\wedge_0^i V$ are irreducible for $i \leq n$, and one can check that these form all of the irreducible representations of $\mathfrak{sp}_{2n}$ (compute their dimensions and compare them to the highest weight representations).

We can also define an operator

$$\begin{aligned} m_B : \wedge^{i-1} V &\longrightarrow \wedge^{i+1} V \\ u &\mapsto B^{-1} \wedge u. \end{aligned}$$

One can check that m_B and i_B together with h (acting as $i - n$ on $\wedge^i V$) form an $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ -triple. Then

$$\wedge V = \bigoplus_{i=0}^n L_{\omega_i} \otimes L_{n-j}$$

(where $\omega_0 = 0$ and L_{n-j} is the representation of $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ of weight $n - j$) as representations of $\mathfrak{sp}_{2n} \oplus \mathfrak{sl}_2$.

4.4 Representations of Orthogonal Lie Algebras

Remark. First consider B_n , which corresponds to $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{so}_{2n+1}$. Let $Q = \sum_{i=1}^n x_i x_{i+n} + x_{2n+1}^2$. In this case, the Cartan subalgebra is given by elements of the form $\text{diag}(a_1, \dots, a_n, -a_1, \dots, -a_n, 0)$. Let V be the $(2n+1)$ -dimensional defining representation. Then for $1 \leq i \leq n-1$, the representation $\wedge^i V$ is irreducible (one can check this using the dimension formula) with highest weight

$$\omega_i = (\underbrace{1, \dots, 1}_i, 0, \dots, 0).$$

On the other hand, $\wedge^n V$ is irreducible but not fundamental, with highest weight $(1, \dots, 1) = 2\omega_n$.

Now we consider the spin representation S (whose elements are called *spinors*). It has weights

$$(\pm 1/2, \pm 1/2, \dots, \pm 1/2)$$

(all possible combinations of $\pm$). The character of S is given by

$$\chi_S(x_1, \dots, x_n) = (x_1^{1/2} + x_1^{-1/2}) \cdots (x_n^{1/2} + x_n^{-1/2}).$$

Remark. We will want to look at the Lie group $\text{Spin}_{2n+1}(\mathbb{C})$, the universal cover of $\text{SO}_{2n+1}(\mathbb{C})$. For $n = 1$, we have $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{so}_3(\mathbb{C}) = \mathfrak{sl}_2(\mathbb{C})$. We will see that S is 2-dimensional, and $\pi_1(\text{SO}_3(\mathbb{C})) = \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$.

Lecture 5

Jan. 28 — Other Classical Lie Algebras, Part 2

5.1 More on Orthogonal Lie Algebras

Proposition 5.1. *For $n \geq 3$, we have $\pi_1(\mathrm{SO}_n(\mathbb{C})) = \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$.*

Proof. There is a deformation retract from the surface X_n defined by $z_1^2 + \cdots + z_n^2 = 1$ in $\mathbb{C}^n$ to the sphere $X_n^{\mathbb{R}} = X_n \cap \mathbb{R}^n$ defined by $x_1^2 + \cdots + x_n^2 = 1$ in $\mathbb{R}^n$: Let $\vec{z} = \vec{x} + i\vec{y} \in X_n$ for $\vec{x}, \vec{y} \in \mathbb{R}^n$, and note that $|\vec{z}|^2 = 1$ if and only if $|\vec{x}|^2 - |\vec{y}|^2 = 1$ and $\vec{x} \cdot \vec{y} = 0$. We also have

$$(\vec{x} + ti\vec{y})^2 = |\vec{x}|^2 - t^2|\vec{y}|^2 = 1 + (1 - t^2)|\vec{y}|^2 \geq 1.$$

So we can define a homotopy $f_t : X_n \rightarrow X_n$ by

$$f_t(\vec{z}) = \frac{\vec{x} + ti\vec{y}}{\sqrt{|\vec{x}|^2 - t^2|\vec{y}|^2}},$$

which satisfies $|f_t(z)|^2 = 1$, $f_1(z) = z$, and $f_0(z) \in X_n^{\mathbb{R}}$. Now observe that SO_n acts on X_n with fibers isomorphic to SO_{n-1} , so we have a long exact sequence

$$\pi_2(X_n) \longrightarrow \pi_1(\mathrm{SO}_{n-1}(\mathbb{C})) \longrightarrow \pi_1(\mathrm{SO}_n(\mathbb{C})) \longrightarrow \pi_1(X_n).$$

The first and last groups are trivial for $n \geq 4$, so we have that $\pi_1(\mathrm{SO}_{n-1}(\mathbb{C})) \cong \pi_1(\mathrm{SO}_n(\mathbb{C}))$. Thus the result follows once one checks that $\pi_1(\mathrm{SO}_3(\mathbb{C})) \cong \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ (left as an exercise). $\square$

Remark. Now consider D_n , which corresponds to $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{so}_{2n}$. Let $Q = \sum_{i=1}^n x_i x_{i+n}$. The elements of the Cartan subalgebra are given by $\mathrm{diag}(a_1, \dots, a_n, -a_1, \dots, -a_n)$. Let V be the $2n$ -dimensional defining representation, and consider $\wedge^i V$ for $1 \leq i \leq n$. We have $\wedge^i V$ is irreducible for $0 \leq i \leq n-1$, and $L_{\omega_i} = \wedge^i V$ for $1 \leq i \leq n-2$. Note that $L_{(1, \dots, 1, 0)}$ is irreducible but not fundamental. Letting

$$\omega_{n-1} = (1/2, \dots, 1/2, 1/2) \quad \text{and} \quad (1/2, \dots, 1/2, -1/2),$$

the corresponding $S_+ = L_{\omega_{n-1}}$ and $S_- = L_{\omega_n}$ are the spin representations. The characters are

$$\chi_{S_{\pm}} = ((x_1^{1/2} + x_1^{-1/2}) \cdots (x_n^{1/2} + x_n^{-1/2}))_{\pm},$$

where the $\pm$ denotes an even or odd number of $-$ signs.

Example 5.0.1. We have $\text{Spin}_4 = \text{SL}_2 \times \text{SL}_2$, where factors correspond to S_+ and S_- . We have $\text{Spin}_5 = \text{Sp}_4$, where S is the 4-dimensional defining representation, and $\text{SO}_5 = \text{Sp}_4/\{\pm 1\}$. We have $\text{Spin}_6 = \text{SL}_4$, where S_+, S_- are the 4-dimensional defining representation and its dual, and $\text{SO}_6 = \text{SL}_4/\{\pm 1\}$.

Example 5.0.2. Let V be a finite-dimensional vector space, and consider $SV = \mathbb{C}[x_1, \dots, x_n]$, where $x_1, \dots, x_n$ is an orthonormal basis. Denote $R^2 = \sum_{i=1}^n x_i^2 = S^2V$ and $\Delta = \sum_{i=1}^n \partial^2/\partial x_i^2$. Then:

1. Find a first-order differential operator making $\{R^2, \Delta, \cdot\}$ an $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ -triple. Make sure that it commutes with the $\text{SO}(V)$ action.
2. Let $H_m \subseteq S^m V$ be the subspace of harmonic polynomials. Then

$$SV = \bigoplus_{m=0}^{\infty} H_m \otimes W_m,$$

where $H_m = L_{m\omega_1}$ is the irreducible representation of $\text{SO}(V)$, and W_m is the Verma module for $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ of highest weight m .

5.2 Clifford Algebras

Definition 5.1. Let V be a finite-dimensional vector space (over $\mathbb{C}$) and $(\cdot, \cdot)$ a non-degenerate inner product on V . Give an associative algebra structure to V by

$$v^2 = \frac{1}{2}(v, v).$$

Such an algebra is called a *Clifford algebra*, and is denoted by $\text{Cl}(V)$.

Corollary 5.0.1. $ab + ba = (a + b)^2 - a^2 - b^2 = (a, b).$

Example 5.1.1. The operators $^i\partial/\partial x_i$ and $dx_i \wedge \cdot$ define a Clifford algebra.

Example 5.1.2. Let $e^i e^j + e^j e^i = \delta_{i,j}$. Then $D = \sum_{i=1}^n e^i \partial_i$ (the *Dirac operator*) satisfies $D^2 = \Delta$.

Theorem 5.1. The algebra $\text{Cl}(V)$ is isomorphic to $\text{Mat}_{2^n}(\mathbb{C})$ if $\dim V = 2n$ and to $\text{Mat}_{2^n}(\mathbb{C}) \oplus \text{Mat}_{2^n}(\mathbb{C})$ if $\dim V = 2n + 1$.

Proof. First consider the even case. Choose a basis $a_1, \dots, a_n, b_1, \dots, b_n$ such that

$$(a_i, a_j) = (b_i, b_j) = 0, \quad (a_i, b_j) = \delta_{i,j}, \quad a_i a_j + a_j a_i = 0, \quad b_i b_j + b_j b_i = 0, \quad b_i a_i + a_i b_i = 1.$$

Consider $\text{Cl}(V)$ -module $M = \wedge(a_1, \dots, a_n)$ (note that $\dim M = 2^n$) with action defined by

$$\rho(a_i)w = a_i w \quad \text{and} \quad \rho(b_i)w = \frac{\partial w}{\partial a_i}.$$

We have the relations

$$1 = \left[a_i, \frac{\partial}{\partial a_i} \right] = a_i \frac{\partial}{\partial a_i} + \frac{\partial}{\partial a_i} a_i \quad \text{and} \quad a_j \frac{\partial}{\partial a_i} = -\frac{\partial}{\partial a_i} a_j$$

for $i \neq j$. Let $c_{I,J} = a_{i_1} \cdots a_{i_k} b_{j_1} \cdots b_{j_m}$ for $I = \{i_1, \dots, i_k\}$ and $J = \{j_1, \dots, j_m\}$. Check as an exercise that the $c_{I,J}$ are linearly independent, then $\rho : \text{Cl}(V) \rightarrow \text{End}(M)$ is an isomorphism.

If $\dim V = 2n + 1$, then we can pick an extra element z satisfying

$$(z, a_i) = (z, b_i) = 0 \quad \text{and} \quad (z, z) = 2,$$

with relations $za_i + a_iz = zb_i + b_iz = 0$ and $z^2 = 1$. Then $zw = \pm(-1)^{\deg w}wz$ for $w \in M_{\pm}$. $\square$

Remark. There is an embedding $\mathfrak{so}(V) \rightarrow \text{Cl}(V)$. Define a map

$$\begin{aligned} \xi : \wedge^2 V = \mathfrak{so}(V) &\longrightarrow \text{Cl}(V) \\ a \wedge b &\longmapsto \frac{1}{2}(ab - ba) = ab - \frac{1}{2}(a, b). \end{aligned}$$

One can check that $[\xi(a \wedge b), \xi(c \wedge d)] = \xi([a \wedge b, c \wedge d])$, so ξ is a homomorphism of Lie algebras. We have ξ^*M for even dimensional V and $\xi^*M_{\pm}$ for odd dimensional V , and

$$\rho_{\xi^*M}(a) = \rho_M(\xi(a))$$

gives ξ^*M the structure of an $\mathfrak{so}(V)$ -representation (and similarly for $\xi^*M_{\pm}$. Notice that χ^*M is reducible:

$$\xi^*M = (\xi^*M)_0 \oplus (\xi^*M)_1$$

as representations, where the first factor corresponds to even degree and the second to odd degree.

Example 5.1.3. We have the following:

1. $(\xi^*M)_0 \cong S_+$ and $(\xi^*M)_1 \cong S_-$ for even dimensional V .
2. If $\dim V$ is odd, then $\chi^*M_{\pm}$ are both isomorphic to S .

Lecture 6

Feb. 2 — Duals, Maximal Weights, Exponents

6.1 Dual Representations

Remark. Let L_λ be the irreducible representation of highest weight λ . What is the highest weight of the dual representation L_λ^* ? Let w_0 be the maximal element in W .

Proposition 6.1. *We have $L_\lambda^* = L_{-w_0(\lambda)}$.*

Proof. Since λ is the highest weight in L_λ , for every weight μ in L_λ we have $\lambda - \mu \in Q_+$. So

$$Q_- \ni w_0(\lambda - \mu) = w_0(\lambda) - w_0(\mu),$$

so $w_0(\mu) - w_0(\lambda) \in Q_+$. Thus $w_0(\lambda) \leq w_0(\mu)$ for all $\mu \in L_\lambda$, so the length of w_0 is $|R_+|$. Thus $-w_0(\lambda)$ is the lowest weight of L_λ , which is the highest weight of L_λ^* . $\square$

Example 6.0.1. Since the length of w_0 is $|R_+|$, w_0 permutes the fundamental (co)weights and (co)roots, so w_0 is an automorphism of Dynkin diagrams. Note that W acts on P/Q , and w_0 acts as inversion.

- The Dynkin diagrams $A_1, B_n, C_n, G_2, F_4, E_7, E_8$ have no automorphisms, so $L_\lambda^* = L_\lambda$ for these.
- For A_n with $n \geq 2$, we have $P/Q = \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ (e.g. if V is the defining representation, then we have that $L_{\omega_1}^* = V^* = \wedge^{n-1}V = L_{\omega_{n-1}}$).
- For E_6 , we have $P/Q = \mathbb{Z}/3\mathbb{Z}$, where w_0 exchanges the two minuscule weights.
- For D_{2n+1} , we have $P/Q = \mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$ and $S_+^* = S_-$. For D_{2n} , $P/Q = \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$, and $S_\pm^* = S_\pm$.

6.2 Maximal Weights

Definition 6.1. Let *maximal weight* of $\mathfrak{g}$, denoted θ , is the highest weight of the adjoint representation.

Example 6.1.1. If $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{sl}_n$, then θ is the highest weight for $V^* \otimes V$ where V is the defining representation. Note that $V^* = \wedge^{n-1}V$, so the highest weight of $V^* \otimes V$ is $\theta = \omega_1 + \omega_{n-1}$. It is not fundamental.

Example 6.1.2. For $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{sp}_{2n}$, we have $\mathfrak{g} = S^2V$ where V is the defining representation for $\mathfrak{sp}_{2n}$. Then $\theta = 2\omega_1$, which is also not fundamental.

Proposition 6.2. *For a simple Lie algebra with $\mathfrak{g} \neq \mathfrak{sl}_n, \mathfrak{sp}_{2n}$, the maximal weight θ is fundamental.*

Example 6.1.3. For $\mathfrak{so}_N$ with $N \geq 7$ (type B or D), we have $\mathfrak{g} = \wedge^2V = L_{\omega_2}$.

6.3 Principal $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ -Subalgebra and Exponents

Definition 6.2. Let $\mathfrak{g}$ be a simple Lie algebra and $\{e_i, f_i, h_i\}$ (where $h_i = \alpha_i^\vee$) be Chevalley generators. Let $e = \sum_{i=1}^r e_i$, and h such that $\alpha_i(h) = 2$ for all i (so $h = 2\rho^\vee$). Note that we have $[h, e] = 2e$ and $h = \sum_{i=1}^r (2\rho^\vee, \omega_i) \alpha_i^\vee$. Let $f = \sum_{i=1}^r (2\rho^\vee, \omega_i) f_i$. Then $\{h, e, f\}$ spans the *principal $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ -subalgebra* of $\mathfrak{g}$.

Example 6.2.1. Let $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{sl}_{n+1}$. Then the restriction of the defining representation to the principal $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ is L_n , the irreducible representation of $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ of highest weight n .

Remark. Let $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{n}_- \oplus \mathfrak{h} \oplus \mathfrak{n}_+$, so that $\mathfrak{g} = \sum \mathfrak{g}[2m]$ where m is the height of the corresponding root subspace (and $2m$ is the weight with respect to h). Note $\mathfrak{g}[0] = \mathfrak{h}$ and $\dim \mathfrak{g}[0] = r$. Let $r_m = \dim \mathfrak{g}[2m]$.

Definition 6.3. We say that m is an *exponent* of $\mathfrak{g}$ if $r_m > r_{m+1}$. The *multiplicity* of an exponent m is $r_m - r_{m+1}$.

Remark. We have $r_0 = r$ and there are r exponents (counted with multiplicities) $m_1 \leq m_2 \leq \dots \leq m_r$. The roots of height 2 are given by $\alpha_i + \alpha_j$ (where i, j are connected in the in the Dynkin diagram). So $r_0 = r_1 = 1$ and $r_2 = r - 1$. Thus $m_1 = 1$ and $m_2 > 1$. We have

$$m_r = (\rho^\vee, \theta) = h_{\mathfrak{g}} - 1,$$

where θ is the highest root. We call $h_{\mathfrak{g}}$ the *Coxeter number* of $\mathfrak{g}$. Note that $\sum_{i=1}^r m_i = |R_+|$.

Proposition 6.3. The restriction of $\mathfrak{g}$ to its principal $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ -subalgebra decomposes as $\bigoplus_{i=1}^r L_{2m_i+1}$.

Example 6.3.1. The exponents for $\mathfrak{sl}_n$ are $1, 2, \dots, n-1$.

Definition 6.4. The *Coxeter number* of $\mathfrak{g}$ is $h_{\mathfrak{g}} = \langle \theta, \rho^\vee \rangle + 1 = m_r + 1$, and the *dual Coxeter number* is

$$h_{\mathfrak{g}}^\vee = \langle \tilde{\theta}^\vee, \rho \rangle + 1,$$

where $\tilde{\theta}^\vee = 2\theta/(\theta, \theta)$. If we normalize $(\theta, \theta) = 2$, then $h_{\mathfrak{g}}^\vee = \frac{1}{2}(\theta, \theta + 2\rho)$, which is the eigenvalue of $\frac{1}{2}C$ (where C is the Casimir operator).

6.4 Complex, Real, and Quaternionic Types

Definition 6.5. Let G be a Lie group. An irreducible representation V of G or $\mathfrak{g}$ is of *complex type* if $V \not\cong V^*$, *real type* if there exists a symmetric isomorphism $V \rightarrow V^*$ (i.e. a symmetric inner product for V), and *quaternionic (or symplectic) type* if the isomorphism is given through an anti-symmetric inner product.

Exercise 6.1. Let V be an irreducible representation of a finite group G . Show that $\text{End}_{\mathbb{R}G}(V)$ (i.e. $V \otimes V^*$) can only be one of three types:

- complex type if $\text{End}_{\mathbb{R}G}(V) \cong \mathbb{C}$,
- real type if $\text{End}_{\mathbb{R}G}(V) \cong \text{Mat}_{2 \times 2}(\mathbb{R})$,
- quaternionic type if $\text{End}_{\mathbb{R}G}(V) \cong \mathbb{H}$.

Example 6.5.1. Let L_n be an irreducible representation of $\mathfrak{sl}_2$. Then L_n is of real type for even n and of quaternionic type for odd n . Thus $L_n = S^n V$ where $V = L_1$ is 2-dimensional. The invariant form on $S^n V$ is $S^n B$, where B is a skew-symmetric invariant form on V .

Proposition 6.4. *Assume $\lambda = -w_0(\lambda)$, so that the corresponding representation is of real or quaternionic type. Then L_λ is of real type if $(2\rho^\vee, \lambda)$ is even and of quaternionic type if it is odd.*

Proof. The number $n = (2\rho^\vee, \lambda)$ is the eigenvalue of h (from the principal $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ -subalgebra) on the highest weight vector. Thus we have a decomposition

$$L_\lambda|_{\mathfrak{sl}_2} = L_n \oplus \bigoplus_{m < n} k_m L_m,$$

where L_n has multiplicity 1. One can determine the type based on L_n . □

6.5 Review of Compact Lie Groups

Remark. Let G be a real Lie group of dimension n . Then $\xi \in \wedge^n \mathfrak{g}^*$ gives a generating n -form ω , which is non-vanishing if ξ is non-vanishing. This gives rise to left- and right-invariant measures μ_L and μ_R on G , which are unique up to a constant. We say that G is *unimodular* if $\mu_L = \mu_R$ (up to constants).

When does $\mu_L = \mu_R$? For a 1-dimensional representation V of G , let $|V|$ be the representation of G on the same space where $\rho_{|V|}(g) = |\rho_V(g)|$ (where $\rho_V : G \rightarrow \text{Aut}(V) = \mathbb{R}^\times$).

Proposition 6.5. *We have $\mu_L = \mu_R$ if and only if $|\wedge^n \mathfrak{g}^*|$ is a trivial representation of G .*

Proof. We have $\mu_L = \mu_R$ if and only if the left-invariant form is right- or left-invariant up to a sign. This is equivalent to $\xi \in \wedge^n \mathfrak{g}^*$ being invariant up to a sign under the action of $\mathfrak{g}$. □

Proposition 6.6. *A compact group is unimodular.*

Proof. For compact groups, the representation $|\wedge^n \mathfrak{g}^*|$ gives a continuous homomorphism $G \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^+$, whose only compact subgroup is $\{1\}$. The result follows by Proposition 6.5. □

Proposition 6.7. *Let V be an irreducible representation of G . Then V admits a G -invariant unitary structure.*

Proof. Take any positive Hermitian form B on V , and define

$$B_{\text{av}}(v, w) = \int_G B(\rho_V(g)v, \rho_V(g)w) dg.$$

This is well-defined and invariant by construction. □

Corollary 6.0.1 (Weyl unitary trick). *Any finite-dimensional representation is completely reducible.*

Proof. Write $V = W \oplus W^\perp$. If W is invariant, then so is $W^\perp$. □

Lecture 7

Feb. 4 — Compact Groups

7.1 More on Exponents

Theorem 7.1 (Chevalley's restriction theorem). *There is an isomorphism $\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{g}]^G \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{h}]^W$.*

Theorem 7.2 (Harish-Chandra theorem). *There is an isomorphism $\mathbb{C}[\mathfrak{h}]^W \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathcal{Z}(U(\mathfrak{g}))$.*

Remark. Pick an ordering $s_{i_1}, \dots, s_{i_r}$ of the simple roots. Then $c = s_{i_1} \cdots s_{i_r}$ is the *Coxeter element*, and $c^h = 1$ where h is the Coxeter number. Then the eigenvalues of c are ζ^{m_i+1} where $\zeta = e^{2\pi i/h}$ and the m_i are the exponents. Also note that $|W| = \prod_{i=1}^r (m_i + 1)$.

If e, f, h is the principal $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ -triple, then one can consider $e + \mathfrak{g}^f$ where $\mathfrak{g}^f = \ker \text{ad}_f$.

7.2 Matrix Coefficients

Remark. For the rest of this lecture, let G be a real compact group and V a finite-dimensional continuous complex representation of G .

Definition 7.1. A *matrix coefficient* of $\rho_V : G \rightarrow \text{GL}(V)$ is a function $G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ of the form

$$g \longmapsto \langle f, \rho_V(g)v \rangle$$

for some $v \in V$ and $f \in V^*$.

Proposition 7.1. *Matrix coefficients are smooth.*

Proof. Call $v \in V$ a smooth vector if $\langle f, \rho_V(g)v \rangle$ is smooth for all $f \in V^*$. It is obvious that such vectors form a subspace of V , call it $V_{\text{sm}} \subseteq V$. Fix $v \in V$ and $\phi : G \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ smooth and with compact support. Let

$$w = w(\phi, v) = \int_G \phi(g) \rho_V(g)v \, dg.$$

We claim that w is smooth. We have

$$f(\rho(h)w) = f\left(\rho_V(h) \int_G \phi(g) \rho_V(g)v \, dg\right) = \int_G f(\phi(g) \rho_V(hg)v) \, dg = \int_G f(\phi(h^{-1}g) \rho_V(g)v) \, dg.$$

Differentiating under the integral sign and noting that $\phi(h^{-1}g)$ is smooth in h , we see that the above expression is smooth in h . Now choose a delta-like sequence ϕ_n with compact support around 1 so that

$$\int_G \phi_n(g) \, dg = 1.$$

Then $w_n = w(\phi_n, v) \rightarrow v$ and each w_n is smooth, so v is smooth. $\square$

Remark. Let V be an irreducible representation of G . Then:

1. V has an invariant positive-definite inner product which is unique up to scaling;
2. one can use an orthonormal basis $v_1, \dots, v_n$ to define matrix coefficients:

$$\psi_{V,i,j}(g) = v_j^*(\rho_V(g)v_i) = (\rho_V(g)v_i, v_j)$$

(note that this definition is independent of normalization).

Theorem 7.3 (Orthonormality of matrix coefficients). *Let V, W be irreducible representations of G .*

1. *If V, W are not isomorphic, then*

$$\int_G \psi_{V,i,j}(g) \bar{\psi}_{W,k,\ell}(g) dg = 0.$$

2. *For $V = W$, we have*

$$\int_G \psi_{V,i,j}(g) \bar{\psi}_{V,k,\ell}(g) dg = \frac{\delta_{i,k} \delta_{j,\ell}}{\dim V}.$$

Proof. Let $\{v_i\}$ and $\{w_k\}$ be orthonormal bases for V and W , respectively. We have

$$\int_G \psi_{V,i,j}(g) \bar{\psi}_{W,k,\ell}(g) dg = \int_G ((\rho_V(g) \otimes \rho_{\bar{W}}(g))(v_i \otimes w_k), v_j \otimes w_\ell) dg$$

Define the operator

$$P = \int_G (\rho_V \otimes \rho_{\bar{W}})(g) dg = \int_G \rho_{V \otimes \bar{W}}(g) dg.$$

Since $\bar{W} \cong W^*$, we have $P : V \otimes W^* \rightarrow V \otimes W^*$. Thus

$$\text{Im } P \subseteq (V \otimes W^*)^G,$$

which is 0 if $V \not\cong W$. On the other hand, if $V \cong W$, then the only invariant is

$$\vec{u} = \sum_k (v_k \otimes \bar{v}_k),$$

so P is the orthogonal projection onto $\vec{u}$. Thus

$$P\vec{x} = \frac{(\vec{x}, \vec{u})}{(\vec{u}, \vec{u})} \vec{u},$$

so we have $(P(v_i \otimes w_k), v_j \otimes w_\ell) = \delta_{i,j} \delta_{k,\ell} / (\dim V)$. $\square$

7.3 Peter-Weyl Theorem

Theorem 7.4 (Peter-Weyl theorem). *The matrix coefficients $\psi_{V,i,j}$ form an orthogonal basis in $L^2(G)$.*

Remark. Let V be a finite-dimensional irrep of G . There is a natural inclusion

$$\begin{aligned} i_V : V^* &\hookrightarrow \text{Hom}_G(V, L^2(G)), \\ f &\longmapsto [v \mapsto (\rho_{V^*}(\cdot)f)(v)]. \end{aligned}$$

We claim that i_V is also surjective. To see this, let $\phi \in \text{Hom}_G(V, L^2(G))$, i.e. an L^2 function left-invariant

under G . Thus we have that

$$\phi(x) = \rho_{V^*}(xg^{-1})\phi(g)$$

(after modifying ϕ on a set of measure zero). Setting $g = 1$, we get $\phi(x) = \rho_{V^*}(x)\phi(1)$, so we have

$$\xi : \bigoplus_{V \in \text{Irr}(G)} V \otimes V^* \cong \bigoplus_{V \in \text{Irr}(G)} V \otimes \text{Hom}_G(V, L^2(G)) \hookrightarrow L^2(G),$$

an embedding of $(G \times G)$ -modules. Call the left-hand side $L^2_{\text{alg}}(G)$.

Theorem 7.5 (Peter-Weyl theorem, alternative). $L^2_{\text{alg}}(G)$ is dense in $L^2(G)$, i.e.

$$L^2(G) = \widehat{\bigoplus_{V \in \text{Irr}(G)} V \otimes V^*}.$$

Example 7.1.1. Let $G = S^1 = U(1)$. The irreducible representations of G are $\psi_n(\theta) = e^{in\theta}$. The $e^{in\theta}$ form a basis of $L^2(G) = L^2(S^1)$, where the norm is given by

$$\|f\|^2 = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} |f(\theta)|^2 d\theta.$$

This is the usual Fourier series on S^1 . The Peter-Weyl theorem extends this to non-abelian groups.

Exercise 7.1. Let G be a compact group and H a closed subgroup of G .

1. Show that $L^2(G/H) = \widehat{\bigoplus_{V \in \text{Irr}(G)} N_H(V)V}$, where $N_H(V) = \dim V^H$ (the space of H -invariants).
2. Let $G = \text{SO}(3)$ and $H = \text{SO}(2)$. Then show that $L^2(G/H) = L^2(S^2) = \widehat{\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} N_H(m)L_{2m}}$, and that $N_H(m) = 1$ for every m .

7.4 Introduction to Quantum Mechanics

Remark. Let $\mathcal{H}$ be a Hilbert space and H a self-adjoint operator on $\mathcal{H}$. The spectrum of H gives the *energy levels* of the system. The elements $\psi(x, y, z) \in L^2(\mathbb{R}^3)$ are called *wave functions*, and we assume that they are normalized so that $\|\psi\|_{L^2} = 1$. This is so that

$$|\psi(x, y, z)|^2 \Delta V$$

gives the probability of a quantum particle to be in the region ΔV .

In general, there is also a time dependence in the wave function ψ , so we have $\psi(x, y, z, t)$. The time dependence is governed by the Schroedinger equation:

$$i\partial_t \psi = H\psi.$$

One can solve this equation via separation of variables, and we can write

$$\psi(x, y, z, t) = \sum_N e^{-iE_N t} \psi_N(x, y, z),$$

where the ψ_N are eigenvectors satisfying $H\psi_N = E_N\psi_N$.

Example 7.1.2. For the hydrogen atom, we have

$$H = -\frac{1}{2}\Delta - \frac{1}{r},$$

where $\Delta = \partial_x^2 + \partial_y^2 + \partial_z^2$ is the Laplacian and $r = \sqrt{x^2 + y^2 + z^2}$. The $\Delta/2$ is called the *kinetic part* of H , and the $1/r$ is called the *potential part* of H .

Lecture 8

Feb. 9 — Hydrogen Atom

8.1 Bound States of the Hydrogen Atom

Remark. We are looking for eigenvectors for $H = -\frac{1}{2}\Delta - \frac{1}{r}$, i.e. $\psi_N \in L^2(\mathbb{R}^3)$ such that $H\psi_N = E_N\psi_N$ with $E_N < 0$. We first write the Laplacian in spherical coordinates:

$$\begin{aligned}\Delta &= \Delta_r + \frac{1}{r}\Delta_{\text{sph}} \\ \Delta_r &= \partial_r^2 + \frac{2}{r}\partial_r \\ \Delta_{\text{sph}} &= \frac{1}{\sin^2\theta}\partial_\phi^2 + \frac{1}{\sin\theta}\partial_\theta(\sin\theta\partial_\theta \cdot),\end{aligned}$$

where ϕ is the angle in the xy -plane and θ is the angle from the positive z -axis. Then we have

$$\partial_r^2\psi + \frac{2}{r}\partial_r\psi + \frac{1}{r^2}\Delta_{\text{sph}}\psi = -2E\psi,$$

which is solved by $\psi(r, \vec{u}) = f(r)\xi(\vec{u})$ for $\vec{u} \in S^2$ satisfying

$$\begin{aligned}\Delta_{\text{sph}}\xi + \lambda\xi &= 0 \\ f''(r) + \frac{2}{r}f'(r) + \left(\frac{2}{r} - \frac{\lambda}{r^2} + 2E\right)f(r) &= 0.\end{aligned}\tag{*}$$

Note that (*) implies Δ_{sph} is rotationally invariant. By the Peter-Weyl theorem, we have

$$L^2(S^2) = \widehat{\bigoplus_{\ell \geq 0} L_{2\ell}},$$

where $S^2 = \text{SO}(3)/\text{SO}(2)$ and $L_{2\ell}$ are the irreps of $\text{SO}(3)$.

Let $Y_\ell^0 \subseteq L_{2\ell}$ be a vector of weight 0, which is invariant under $\text{SO}(2)$. Thus it depends only on θ . So we can write $Y_\ell^0(\theta) = P_\ell(\cos\theta)$, where P is a polynomial of degree ℓ . By orthogonality,

$$\int_{-1}^1 P_k(z)P_\ell(z) dz = 0, \quad k \neq \ell.$$

Thus we can write

$$-\lambda_e P_\ell(z) = \Delta_{\text{sph}} P_\ell(z) = \partial_z(1-z^2)\partial_z P_\ell(z).$$

From looking at the leading term we must have $\lambda_\ell = \ell(\ell+1)$.

Now take $Y_\ell^m \in L_{2\ell}$ for $-\ell \leq m \leq \ell$. Write $Y_\ell^m(\phi, \theta) = e^{im\phi} P_\ell^m(\cos \theta)$. So we have

$$\frac{-m^2}{1-z^2} P_\ell^m + \partial_z(1-z^2) \partial_z P_\ell^m + \ell(\ell+1) P_\ell^m = 0, \quad -\ell \leq m \leq \ell.$$

This equation has a unique solution (up to scaling) on $[-1, 1]$, given by

$$P_\ell^m = (1-z^2)^{m/2} \partial_z^{\ell+m} (1-z^2)^\ell.$$

Now we return to the radial equation:

$$f''(r) + \frac{2}{r} f'(r) + \left(\frac{2}{r} - \frac{\ell(\ell+1)}{r^2} + 2E \right) f(r) = 0.$$

Write $f(r) = r^\ell e^{-r/n} h(2r/n)$, where n is to be chosen later and h satisfies

$$\rho h''(\rho) + (2\ell + 2 - \rho) h'(\rho) + \left(n - \ell - 1 + \frac{1}{4}(1 + 2En^2) \rho \right) h(\rho) = 0.$$

Now choose $n = 1/\sqrt{-2E}$, so that $E = -1/2n^2$. Then the above equation becomes

$$\rho h''(\rho) + (2\ell + 2 - \rho) h'(\rho) + (n - \ell - 1) h(\rho) = 0.$$

This equation is known as the *generalized Laguerre equation*. To get $\|\psi\|_{L^2}^2 < \infty$, we must have

$$\int_0^\infty \rho^{2\ell+2} e^{-\rho} |h(\rho)|^2 d\rho < \infty,$$

where the extra $+2$ in $\rho^{2\ell+2}$ comes from the Jacobian. Solutions around 0 behave like $\rho^s(1 + o(1))$, so

$$s(s + 2\ell + 1) = 0.$$

Thus either $s = 0$ or $s = -2\ell - 1$.

First consider when $\ell = 0$. Then $s = -1$ and we have $\rho^{-1}(1 + o(1))$, so $\psi \sim 1/r$ as $r \rightarrow 0$. Then

$$H\psi = E\psi + C\delta_0,$$

where δ_0 is the delta function at 0, so we do not get an eigenvector in this case.

Thus $s = -2\ell - 1$. Expanding $h(\rho)$ in a series and substituting, we get the recursive formula

$$h_n(\rho) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(1 + \ell - n) \cdots (k + \ell - n)}{(2\ell + 2) \cdots (2\ell + 1 + k) k!} \rho^k.$$

This series converges, and we have

$$\lim_{\rho \rightarrow \infty} \frac{h_n(\rho)}{\rho} = 1$$

unless the series terminates. Thus $n - \ell - 1 \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$, so we can write

$$h_n(\rho) = \sum_{k=0}^{n-\ell-1} \frac{(1 + \ell - n) \cdots (k + \ell - n)}{(2\ell + 2) \cdots (2\ell + 1 + k) k!} \rho^k = L_{n-\ell-1}^{2\ell+1}(\rho),$$

which is known as the *generalized Laguerre polynomial*:

$$L_N^\alpha(\rho) = \sum_{k=0}^N (-1)^k \frac{N \cdots (N - k + 1)}{(\alpha + 1) \cdots (\alpha + k) k!} \rho^k.$$

Theorem 8.1. *The bound states (i.e. solutions to $H\psi = E\psi$ in $L^2(\mathbb{R}^3)$) of the hydrogen atom are*

$$\psi_{n,\ell,m}(r, \phi, \theta) = r^\ell e^{-r/n} L_{n-\ell-1}^{2\ell+1}(2r/n) Y_\ell^m(\theta, \phi),$$

where $n \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$, ℓ is an integer from $0, \dots, n-1$, $E_n = -1/2n^2$, and m is an integer between $-\ell, \dots, \ell$.

Remark. In Theorem 8.1, n is known as the *principal quantum number*, and ℓ is known as the *azimuthal quantum number*. Note that if $\vec{L}^2 = L_x^2 + L_y^2 + L_z^2 = -\Delta_{\text{sph}}$, where iL_x, iL_y, iL_z are the generators of $\mathfrak{so}(3)$ satisfying $[L_x, L_y] = -iL_z$, then $\vec{L}^2 = C = \ell(\ell+1)$ is the Casimir operator.

Corollary 8.1.1. *The space W_n of states with principal number n has dimension n^2 .*

Proof. This follows from $\sum_{\ell=0}^{n-1} (2\ell+1) = n^2$. □

Remark. Note that $\widehat{\bigoplus_n W_n}$ forms a proper, closed subspace $L_0^2(\mathbb{R}^3)$ of $L^2(\mathbb{R}^3)$. We need to find all φ with $(H\varphi, \varphi) \geq 0$ to reconstruct all of $L^2(\mathbb{R}^3)$. This corresponds to the continuous spectrum of H .

8.2 Spin

Remark. *Spin* is a kind of intrinsic angular momentum. Instead of just $L^2(\mathbb{R}^3)$, we should consider

$$L^2(\mathbb{R}^3) \otimes \mathbb{C}^2 = L^2(\mathbb{R}^3) \otimes L_1$$

to be the space of states for the hydrogen atom. We have

$$V_n = (L_0 \oplus L_2 \oplus \dots \oplus L_{2n-2}) \otimes L_1 = 2L_1 \oplus 2L_3 \oplus \dots \oplus 2L_{2n-3} \oplus 2L_{2n-1},$$

so $\dim V_n = 2n^2$. We have an additional *spin operator* given by

$$S_z = \begin{pmatrix} 1/2 & 0 \\ 0 & -1/2 \end{pmatrix},$$

which acts on $\mathbb{C}^2$ in the standard basis e_+, e_- . Then we have

$$\psi_{n,\ell,m,+} = \psi_{n,\ell,m} \otimes e_+ \quad \text{and} \quad \psi_{n,\ell,m,-} = \psi_{n,\ell,m} \otimes e_-.$$

The *total spin* is $m + s$ (where s is the eigenvalue for S_z), which is either $m + 1/2$, or $m - 1/2$.

8.3 Pauli Exclusion Principle

Remark. The space $\wedge^k V_n$ corresponds to the space of states for k electrons at energy level n . Note that we must have $k \leq 2n^2$ to have $\wedge^k V_n \neq 0$, which gives the *Pauli exclusion principle*.

In the periodic table, one has *orbitals* s, p, d, f corresponding to $\ell = 0, 1, 2, 3$, respectively, written with coefficient n and with exponent k corresponding to the number of electrons in the orbital. For example, the element Ruthenium has

$$1s^2 2s^2 2p^6 3s^2 3p^6 3d^{10} 4s^2 4p^6 4d^7 5s^1.$$

The periodic table is organized as follows: from left to right ordered by how many *valent* electrons (i.e. the number of electrons in the outermost orbital), and from top to bottom ordered by how many energy levels. For Ruthenium, it is on column 8 and row 5. The number is 44, for 44 total electrons.

Exercise 8.1. Let $\vec{r} = (x, y, z)$ and $\vec{p} = (-\partial_x, -i\partial_y, -i\partial_z)$ be the *position* and *momentum* operators. Let $\vec{L} = \vec{r} \times \vec{p}$ and $H = \frac{1}{2}\vec{p}^2 + U(r)$, where U is rotationally invariant. Show that:

1. The components $i\vec{L}$ are generators of the rotations on $\mathbb{R}^3$, and $[\vec{L}, \vec{p}^2] = 0$.
2. $\vec{A}_0 = \frac{1}{2}(\vec{p} \times \vec{L} - \vec{L} \times \vec{p})$ satisfies $[\vec{A}_0, \vec{p}^2] = 0$.
3. Let $A = \vec{A}_0 + \phi(r)\vec{r}$. There exists ϕ such that $[\vec{A}, H] = 0$ if and only if U is a *Columb potential* (i.e. $U(r) = \frac{C}{r} + D$), and in this case ϕ is completely determined.
4. (Hidden symmetry of the hydrogen atom) Use the commutation relations between $\vec{A}$ and $\vec{L}$ to define an action on $\mathfrak{so}_4 = \mathfrak{so}_3 \oplus \mathfrak{so}_3$, so that $\vec{L}$ is the diagonal copy in this decomposition.
5. $W_n = L_{n-1} \boxtimes L_{n-1}$ as representations of $\mathfrak{so}_4 = \mathfrak{so}_3 \oplus \mathfrak{so}_3 = \mathfrak{sl}_2 \oplus \mathfrak{sl}_2$.

Lecture 9

Feb. 11 — Real Forms

9.1 Automorphisms of Semisimple Lie Algebras

Remark. Recall that we can identify $\text{Aut}(\mathfrak{g})$ with a Lie group with Lie algebra $\mathfrak{g}$. The connected component of the identity $\text{Aut}^0(\mathfrak{g})$ (also known as the *adjoint group* G_{ad}) acts transitively on the set of Cartan subalgebras. If $\mathfrak{h} \subseteq \mathfrak{g}$ is a Cartan subalgebra, then there is a connected subgroup $H \subseteq G_{\text{ad}}$ which acts as 1 on $\mathfrak{h}$ and as $e^{\alpha(x)}$ on g_α for $x \in \mathfrak{h}$. Then we have

$$\mathfrak{h}/2\pi i P^\vee \cong H,$$

and H is called a *maximal torus*.

Proposition 9.1. *The normalizer $N(H)$ of H in G_{ad} coincides with the stabilizer of $\mathfrak{h}$ and contains H as a normal subgroup such that $N(H)/H = W$ (the Weyl group).*

Proof. Note that $\text{SL}_2(\mathbb{C})$ is simply connected, so for any simple root α_i there is a homomorphism

$$\eta_i : \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{C}) \longrightarrow G_{\text{ad}} = \tilde{G}/\mathcal{Z}(\tilde{G}).$$

Define $S_i = \eta_i \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{smallmatrix} \right)$. Consider $w = s_{i_1} \cdots s_{i_n}$ and $\tilde{w} = S_{i_1} \cdots S_{i_n}$. Note that $\tilde{w}$ acts on $\mathfrak{h}$ acts w , and if $w = w_1 w_2$, then $\tilde{w} = \tilde{w}_1 \tilde{w}_2 h$ for some $h \in H$. To see the latter claim, note that h has the preserve the root decomposition, hence $h|_{\mathfrak{g}_{\alpha_j}} = \exp(b_j)$. Thus $h = \exp(\sum_j b_j w_j^\vee) \in H$ (where $\langle w_j^\vee, \alpha_i \rangle = \delta_{j,i}$).

So $\tilde{w}$ and H generate a subgroup $N \subseteq N(H)$ such that $N/H = W$. It remains to show that $N(H) = N$. Let $x \in N(H)$ and consider simple roots $\alpha'_i = x(\alpha_i)$. Then there exists $w \in W$ such that $w(\alpha'_i) = \alpha_{p(i)}$ for some permutation p . Then $\tilde{w}x(\alpha_i) = \alpha_{p(i)}$, so this is a Dynkin diagram automorphism. Now $\tilde{w}x$ is an element of a group, so the fundamental weights are fixed. Thus $p = \text{id}$. $\square$

Remark. Although $N(H)/H = W$, in general $N(H)$ is not a semidirect product of H and W .

Proposition 9.2. *The map $\xi : \text{Aut}(D) \ltimes G_{\text{d}} \rightarrow \text{Aut}(\mathfrak{g})$ is an isomorphism.*

Proof. We have to show that ξ is surjective. Let $a \in \text{Aut}(\mathfrak{g})$. We can say that a preserves the Cartan subalgebra (if not, we can shift it by $g \in G_{\text{ad}}$). Multiplying by $\text{Aut}(D)N(H)$, we can make it act trivially on $\mathfrak{h}$ and $\mathfrak{g}_{\alpha_i}$. Then $a = 1$, so $a \in \text{Im } \xi$. $\square$

9.2 Real Forms of Semisimple Lie Algebras

Remark. Recall the Serre presentation for $\mathfrak{g}$, i.e. generators $\{h_i, f_i, e_i\}$ with certain relations. In this setting, everything was defined over $\mathbb{Q}$.

Definition 9.1. A semisimple Lie algebra is *split* if it admits a Chevalley-Serre basis over base field K .

Remark. Let L be a Galois extension of K ($\text{char } K = 0$), and assume that $\mathfrak{g}_L$ is a split semisimple Lie algebra. We want to find $\mathfrak{g}$ over K such that $\mathfrak{g} \otimes_K L = \mathfrak{g}_L$. The problem is then to find a classification of all such $\mathfrak{g}$. Let $\Gamma = \text{Gal}(L/K)$. Define an action of Γ on $\mathfrak{g}_L$ by

$$g(\lambda x) = g(\lambda)g(x), \quad x \in \mathfrak{g}_L, \lambda \in L, g \in \Gamma,$$

which is twisted linear. We can reconstruct $\mathfrak{g}$ as the invariants $\mathfrak{g}_L^\Gamma$.

The simplest action of this kind is $\rho_0(g)$, which acts on scalars and preserves $\{h_i, e_i, f_i\}$. Any twisted linear action takes the form $\rho(g) = \eta(g)\rho_0(g)$ for some $\eta : \Gamma \rightarrow \text{Aut}(\mathfrak{g}_L)$. As ρ is a homomorphism,

$$\eta(gh)\rho_0(gh) = \eta(g)\rho_0(g)\eta(h)\rho_0(h),$$

and upon rearranging, we have

$$\eta(gh) = \eta(g)g(\eta(h)),$$

where $g(a) = \rho_0(g)a\rho_0(g)^{-1}$ for $a \in \text{Aut}(\mathfrak{g}_L)$. The above is called a *1-cocycle condition*.

Denote the Lie algebra associated to the cocycle η by $\mathfrak{g}_\eta$. When do we have $\mathfrak{g}_{\eta_1} \cong \mathfrak{g}_{\eta_2}$? This is the case when ρ_1 and ρ_2 are isomorphic, i.e. there exists $a \in \text{Aut}(\mathfrak{g}_L)$ such that $\rho_1(g)a = a\rho_2(g)$. Then

$$\eta_1(g)\rho_0(g)a = a\eta_2(g)\rho_0(g),$$

so $\eta_1(g) = a\eta_2(g)g(a)^{-1}$. Thus η_1 and η_2 are cohomologous cocycles.

Proposition 9.3. *The semisimple Lie algebras $\mathfrak{g}$ over K which split over L (where L/K is Galois) are classified by $H^1(\Gamma, \text{Aut}(\mathfrak{g}_L))$, where $\Gamma = \text{Gal}(L/K)$.*

Remark. We will now specialize to $K = \mathbb{R}$, $L = \mathbb{C}$, where $\Gamma = \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$, generated by complex conjugation. We have $\text{Aut}(\mathfrak{g}_L) = \text{Aut}(D) \rtimes G_{\text{ad}}$. Since $\eta(1) = 1$, η is determined by $\eta(-1)$. The cocycle condition is

$$s\bar{s} = 1, \quad s = \eta(-1).$$

The corresponding Lie algebra (up to isomorphism) depends only on the cohomology class of s , where $s \rightarrow as\bar{a}^{-1}$ for $a \in \text{Aut}(D)$.

Theorem 9.1. *The real semisimple Lie algebras whose complexification is $\mathfrak{g}$ (i.e. the real forms of $\mathfrak{g}$) are classified by $s \in \text{Aut}(D) \rtimes G_{\text{ad}}$ such that $s\bar{s} = 1$, modulo the equivalence $s \rightarrow as\bar{a}^{-1}$ for $a \in \text{Aut}(D)$.*

Remark. Note that complex conjugation acts trivially on $\text{Aut}(D)$.

Remark. Denote by $\mathfrak{g}_{(s)} = \{x \in \mathfrak{g} : \bar{x} = s(x)\}$ the real form corresponding to s . Denote by $\mathfrak{g}_{(1)}$ the split form consisting of real $x \in \mathfrak{g}$ (so that $x = \bar{x}$).

Alternatively, we can define an antilinear involution $\sigma_s(x) = \overline{s(x)}$. Then $\mathfrak{g}_{(s)}$ is the fixed point set of σ_s .

Remark. Note that s defines $s_0 \in \text{Aut}(D)$ with $s_0^2 = 1$.

Corollary 9.1.1. *The conjugacy class of s_0 is invariant under equivalences.*

Remark. Since s_0 permutes the connected components of the Dynkin diagram D , it preserves some and divides some into pairs. So every semisimple real Lie algebra is a direct sum of simple ones, and each simple one has either connected Dynkin diagram or consists of two identical components.

Remark. We now consider the case when D is connected and $\mathfrak{g}$ is simple.

Definition 9.2. A real form $\mathfrak{g}_{(s)}$ of a complex simple Lie algebra is said to be *inner to* $\mathfrak{g}_{(s')}$ if $s' = gs$ up to equivalence, where $g \in G_{\text{ad}}$ (i.e. s, s' differ by an inner automorphism). The *inner class* of $\mathfrak{g}_{(s)}$ is the collection of all real forms inner to $\mathfrak{g}_{(s)}$. An *inner form* is a form inner to a split form. We call $\mathfrak{g}_{(s)}$ *quasi-split* if $s = s_0 \in \text{Aut}(D)$.

Corollary 9.1.2. *We have the following:*

1. *Any real form is inner to a unique quasi-split form.*
2. *A real form which is both inner and quasi-split is split.*

Example 9.2.1. Consider the *Cartan involution* τ defined by

$$\tau(h_j) = -h_j, \quad \tau(e_j) = -f_j, \quad \tau(f_j) = -e_j.$$

Then $\mathfrak{g}_{(\tau)} = \mathfrak{g}^c$ is called the *compact real form* of $\mathfrak{g}$.

Lecture 10

Feb. 16 — Real Forms, Part 2

10.1 Compact Real Forms

Proposition 10.1. *Let τ be the Cartan involution (defined in Example 9.2.1) and $\mathfrak{g}^c = \mathfrak{g}_{(\tau)}$. Then the Killing form of $\mathfrak{g}^c$ is negative definite.*

Proof. We can write $\mathfrak{g}^c = (\mathfrak{h} \cap \mathfrak{g}^c) \oplus \bigoplus_{\alpha \in R_+} (\mathfrak{g}_\alpha \oplus \mathfrak{g}_{-\alpha}) \cap \mathfrak{g}^c$. The Killing form is negative definite on $\mathfrak{h} \cap \mathfrak{g}^c$ since the inner product on a coroot lattice is positive definite. Thus it is negative definite on $\mathfrak{g}^c$, as $\{i\alpha_j^\vee\}$ is a basis for $\mathfrak{g}^c \cap \mathfrak{h}$. Now we need to show that it is negative definite on $(\mathfrak{g}_\alpha \oplus \mathfrak{g}_{-\alpha}) \cap \mathfrak{g}^c$. Note that for $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{sl}_2$, we have a basis for $\mathfrak{g}^c$ given by $ih, e - f, i(e + f)$, so $\mathfrak{g}^c = \mathfrak{su}(2)$. So the statement holds there. For general $\mathfrak{g}$, we have that S_i preserves $\mathfrak{g}^c$, since

$$S = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{SU}(2).$$

So we have $\mathrm{Lie}(\mathrm{SU}(2)_i) \subseteq \mathfrak{g}^c$. For any $w \in W$, the lift $\tilde{w}$ preserves $\mathfrak{g}^c$, so the restriction of the Killing form of $\mathfrak{g}^c$ to $\mathfrak{g}^c \cap (\mathfrak{sl}_2)_\alpha$ is negative definite. $\square$

Remark. Consider $\mathrm{Aut}(\mathfrak{g}^c)$. Since the Killing form is negative definite, $\mathrm{Aut}(\mathfrak{g}^c)$ is a closed subgroup of $\mathrm{O}(\mathfrak{g}^c)$, so it is compact. Moreover, this is a Lie group with Lie algebra $\mathfrak{g}^c$.

Corollary 10.0.1. $G_{\mathrm{ad}}^c = \mathrm{Aut}(\mathfrak{g}^c)^\circ$ is a connected, compact Lie group with Lie algebra $\mathfrak{g}^c$.

Example 10.0.1. We have the following:

1. For $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{sl}_n$, we have $G_{\mathrm{ad}}^c = \mathrm{PSU}(n) = \mathrm{SU}(n)/\mu_n$, where μ_n is the n th roots of unity.
2. For $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{so}_n$, we have $G_{\mathrm{ad}}^c = \mathrm{SO}(n)$ for odd n and $G_{\mathrm{ad}}^c = \mathrm{SO}(n)/\{\pm 1\}$ for even n .
3. For $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{sp}_{2n}$, we have $G_{\mathrm{ad}}^c = \mathrm{U}(n, \mathbb{H})/\{\pm 1\}$. The group

$$\mathrm{U}(n, \mathbb{H}) = \mathrm{Sp}_{2n}(\mathbb{C}) \cap \mathrm{U}(2n)$$

is called the *quaternionic unitary group*.

Example 10.0.2. We have the following:

1. Consider A_{n-1} , which corresponds to the split form $\mathfrak{sl}(n, \mathbb{R})$ and compact form $\mathfrak{su}(n)$. For $n > 2$, we have a quasi-split real form as follows: Let $s(A) = -JA^T J^{-1}$ where $J_{i,j} = (-1)^i \delta_{i,n+1-j}$. Then

$$e_i, f_i, h_i, \mapsto e_{n+1-i}, f_{n+1-i}, h_{n+1-i}.$$

Note that J is a Hermitian or skew-Hermitian form of signature (p, p) with $n = 2p$ or of signature $(p+1, p), (p, p+1)$, which are isomorphic when $n = 2p+1$.

For $n = 2$, we have $\mathfrak{su}(1, 1) = \mathfrak{sl}(2, \mathbb{R})$ (and $\mathrm{PSU}(1, 1) = \mathrm{PSL}(2, \mathbb{R})$).¹

2. For type B_n , we have compact form $\mathfrak{so}(2n+1)$ and split form $\mathfrak{so}(n+1, n)$. There are no nontrivial automorphisms, so there are no non-split quasi-split forms.

Particular cases of interest are $\mathrm{SO}(3) \cong \mathrm{SU}(2)$ and $\mathrm{SO}^+(2, 1) = \mathrm{PSU}(1, 1) = \mathrm{PSL}(2, \mathbb{R})$.

3. For type C_n , we have the split form $\mathfrak{sp}(2n, \mathbb{R})$ and compact form $\mathfrak{u}(n, \mathbb{H})$. There are no non-split quasi-split real forms, as there are no nontrivial automorphisms of the Dynkin diagram.

Note that $B_2 = C_2$, so we have $\mathfrak{so}(3, 2) = \mathfrak{sp}_4(\mathbb{R})$ and $\mathfrak{so}(5) = \mathfrak{u}(2, \mathbb{H})$.

4. For type D_n , we have split form $\mathfrak{so}(n, n)$ and compact form $\mathfrak{so}(2n)$. For $n > 4$, there is a unique nontrivial involution, while for $n = 4$, we have $\mathrm{Aut}(D) = S_3$. However, there is still a unique non-split quasi-split form as there is only one nontrivial involution up to conjugation. Recall

$$A = -JA^T J^{-1}, \quad J_{i,j} = \delta_{i, 2n+1-j}.$$

Then the quasi-split form is given by $J \mapsto J' = gJ$, where g permutes e_n, e_{n+1} (which corresponds to α_{n-1}, α_n). The signature defined by J' is $(n+1, n-1)$, so the quasi-split form is $\mathfrak{so}(n+1, n-1)$.

Note that $D_2 = A_1 \oplus A_1$, so we have the following isomorphisms:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathfrak{so}(4) &= \mathfrak{su}(2) \oplus \mathfrak{su}(2), \\ \mathfrak{so}(2, 2) &= \mathfrak{su}(1, 1) \oplus \mathfrak{su}(1, 1), \\ \mathfrak{so}(3, 1) &= \mathfrak{sl}_2(\mathbb{C}), \end{aligned}$$

where in the last isomorphism we view $\mathfrak{sl}_2(\mathbb{C})$ as a real Lie algebra.

We also have $D_3 = A_3$, which gives the following isomorphisms:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathfrak{so}(6) &= \mathfrak{su}(4), \\ \mathfrak{so}(3, 3) &= \mathfrak{sl}_4(\mathbb{R}), \\ \mathfrak{so}(4, 2) &= \mathfrak{su}(2, 2). \end{aligned}$$

10.2 Classification of Real Forms

Remark. Write $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{g}^c \otimes_{\mathbb{R}} \mathbb{C}$ and $\omega = \sigma_{\tau}$ the Cartan antilinear involution (so that $\mathfrak{g}^c$ is the fixed points of σ_{τ}). Another real structure on $\mathfrak{g}$ is given by $\sigma = \omega \circ g$ for $g \in \mathrm{Aut}(\mathfrak{g})$, as

$$\sigma^2 = \omega \circ g \circ \omega \circ g = 1$$

(note that $\omega \circ \omega = \mathrm{id}$, and $\omega(g)g = 1$). Define

$$(X, Y) = \mathrm{tr}(\mathrm{ad}_X \mathrm{ad}_{\omega(Y)}),$$

which is the Hermitian extension of the Killing form from $\mathfrak{g}^c$ to $\mathfrak{g}$. Note that $\omega(g) = (g^{\dagger})^{-1}$, where $g^{\dagger}$ is the adjoint of g . Thus we see that g is self-adjoint.

¹Note that $\mathrm{PSU}(1, 1)$ is the group of automorphisms of the unit disk, and $\mathrm{PSL}(2, \mathbb{R})$ is the group of automorphisms of the upper half-plane. The isomorphism comes from the Cayley transform from the unit disk to the upper half-plane.

In particular, g is diagonalizable with real eigenvalues. So we can write

$$\mathfrak{g} = \bigoplus_{\gamma \in \mathbb{R}} \mathfrak{g}(\gamma),$$

where $\mathfrak{g}(\gamma)$ is the eigenspace of $\mathfrak{g}$ corresponding to eigenvalue γ . Note that

$$[\mathfrak{g}(\beta), \mathfrak{g}(\gamma)] = \mathfrak{g}(\beta\gamma).$$

Consider the operator $|g|^t$ for $t \in \mathbb{R}$, which acts on $\mathfrak{g}(\gamma)$ as $|\gamma|^t$. We can rewrite

$$|g|^t = \exp(t \log |g|) \in G_{\text{ad}},$$

which is a 1-parameter subgroup of G_{ad} . Then we can define $\theta := g|g|^{-1}$, and we have

$$\begin{cases} \theta \circ \omega = \omega \circ \theta, \\ \theta^2 = 1, \end{cases}$$

where the first identity follows from $(\theta^\dagger)^{-1} = \theta$. We have

$$\theta = |g|^{-1/2} g \omega(|g|^{1/2}).$$

We can assume $g = \theta$ with $\theta \circ \omega = \omega \circ \theta$, or equivalently, that $\theta \in \text{Aut}(\mathfrak{g}^c)$ and $\theta^2 = 1$. Thus θ has ± 1 eigenspaces. Note that θ' defines the same real form if and only if

$$\theta' = x\theta(\omega(x))^{-1}$$

for some $x \in \text{Aut}(\mathfrak{g})$. Then we have $x\theta(\omega(x))^{-1} = \omega(x)\theta x^{-1}$ (since $\theta'^2 = 1$, so $\theta'^{-1} = \theta'$). Let

$$z = (\omega(x))^{-1}x,$$

so that $\omega(z) = z^{-1}$. Then $\theta z = z^{-1}\theta$. Now note that $z = x^\dagger x$ is positive definite, so if $y = xz^{-1/2}$,

$$\omega(y) = \omega(x)z^{1/2} = (x^\dagger)^{-1}z^{1/2} = xz^{-1/2} = y.$$

Thus $y \in \text{Aut}(\mathfrak{g}^c)$, and we also have that

$$\theta' = x\theta\omega(x)^{-1} = x\theta z x^{-1} = xz^{-1/2}\theta z^{1/2}x^{-1} = y\theta y^{-1}.$$

Theorem 10.1. *The real forms of $\mathfrak{g}$ are in one-to-one correspondence with the conjugacy classes of involutions $\theta \in \text{Aut}(\mathfrak{g}^c)$, where $\theta \mapsto \omega_\theta = \theta \circ \omega = \omega \circ \theta$.*

Remark. For $\theta : \mathfrak{g} \rightarrow \mathfrak{g}$, denote by $\mathfrak{g}_\theta$ the corresponding real form. For example,

$$\mathfrak{g}_1 = \mathfrak{g}^c = \mathfrak{g}_{(\tau)},$$

where the latter is our old notation using the split forms.

Remark. We now have a canonical (up to automorphisms of $\mathfrak{g}^c$) decomposition

$$\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{k} \oplus \mathfrak{p},$$

where $\theta = 1$ on $\mathfrak{k}$ and $\theta = -1$ on $\mathfrak{p}$. Here $\mathfrak{k}$ is a Lie subalgebra and $[\mathfrak{p}, \mathfrak{p}] \subseteq \mathfrak{k}$. For $\mathfrak{g}^c$ itself, we have

$$\mathfrak{g}^c = \mathfrak{k}^c \oplus \mathfrak{p}^c.$$

Moreover, we have $\mathfrak{g}_\theta = \mathfrak{k}^c \oplus \mathfrak{p}_\theta$, where $\mathfrak{p}_\theta = i\mathfrak{p}^c$ (a fixed point of $\sigma = \omega \circ \theta$ has to have an extra $-$ sign, which we can achieve by multiplying by i).

Exercise 10.1. Show that $\mathfrak{k}$ is reductive but not necessarily semisimple.

Lecture 11

Feb. 18 — Real Forms, Part 3

11.1 Classification of Real Forms, Continued

Proposition 11.1. *There exists a Cartan subalgebra $\mathfrak{h}$ in $\mathfrak{g}$ which is invariant under θ and such that $\mathfrak{h} \cap \mathfrak{k}$ is a Cartan subalgebra in $\mathfrak{k}$.*

Proof. Consider a generic element $t \in \mathfrak{k}^c$. It is regular and semisimple. Consider $\mathfrak{h}_+^c$, the centralizer of t in $\mathfrak{k}^c$. Then necessarily $\mathfrak{h}_+ := \mathfrak{h}_+^c \otimes_{\mathbb{R}} \mathbb{C}$ is a Cartan subalgebra in $\mathfrak{k}$. Let $\mathfrak{h}_-^c$ be a maximal subspace of $\mathfrak{p}^c$ so that $\mathfrak{h}^c = \mathfrak{h}_+^c \oplus \mathfrak{h}_-^c$ is a commutative subalgebra of $\mathfrak{g}^c$. Then we claim that $\mathfrak{h} = \mathfrak{h}^c \otimes_{\mathbb{R}} \mathbb{C}$ is a Cartan subalgebra of $\mathfrak{g}$. Note that $\mathfrak{h}$ consists of the semisimple elements, and all elements in $\mathfrak{g}^c$ are anti-self-adjoint operators. If $z \in \mathfrak{g}$ commutes with $\mathfrak{h}$, then

$$z = z_+ + z_-, \quad z_+ \in \mathfrak{k}, z_- \in \mathfrak{p},$$

where $z_{\pm}$ commute with $\mathfrak{h}$. Then $z_+ \in \mathfrak{h}_+$, and

$$z_- = x + iy, \quad x, y \in \mathfrak{p}^c,$$

where x, y commute with $\mathfrak{h}$. Then $x, y \in \mathfrak{h}_-^c$ (by the definition of $\mathfrak{h}_-^c$), so $z \in \mathfrak{h}$. □

Corollary 11.0.1. *We have $\mathfrak{h} = \mathfrak{h}_+ \oplus \mathfrak{h}_-$, where $\theta = 1$ on $\mathfrak{h}_+$ and $\theta = -1$ on $\mathfrak{h}_-$.*

Lemma 11.1. *There are no coroots of $\mathfrak{g}$ in $\mathfrak{h}_-$.*

Proof. Suppose otherwise that $\alpha^\vee \in \mathfrak{h}_-$. Then $\theta(\alpha^\vee) = -\alpha^\vee$, so

$$\theta(e_\alpha) = e_{-\alpha} \quad \text{and} \quad \theta(e_{-\alpha}) = e_\alpha$$

for some $e_{\pm\alpha} \in \mathfrak{g}_{\pm\alpha}$. Then $x = e_\alpha + e_{-\alpha}$ satisfies $\theta(x) = x$, so $x \in \mathfrak{k}$. But $x \notin \mathfrak{h}_+$ (since $x \perp \mathfrak{h}_+$). Thus $[\mathfrak{h}_+, x] = 0$ since α vanishes on $\mathfrak{h}_+$, a contradiction as $\mathfrak{h}_+$ is a maximal commutative subalgebra of $\mathfrak{k}$. □

Remark. Pick a generic element $t \in \mathfrak{h}_+$, which is regular in $\mathfrak{g}$. Choose t so that

$$\operatorname{Re}(t, \alpha^\vee) \neq 0$$

for all $\alpha^\vee$ of $\mathfrak{g}$. Then we can define a *polarization* on R by

$$R_+ = \{\alpha \in R : \operatorname{Re}(t, \alpha^\vee) > 0\}$$

which satisfies $\theta(R_+) = R_+$. Now $\{\theta(i) : i \in D\}$ gives the action of θ : If $\theta = i$, then

$$\theta(e_i) = \pm e_i, \quad \theta(h_i) = h_i, \quad \theta(f_i) = \pm f_i.$$

Otherwise, if $\theta(i) \neq i$, then we can choose generators $h_i, e_i, e_{\theta(i)}, f_i, f_{\theta(i)}, h_{\theta(i)}$ such that

$$\theta(x_i) = x_{\theta(i)}, \quad x = e, f, h.$$

We can then construct *markings* on the Dynkin diagram as follows:

- Connect vertices i and $\theta(i)$ if $\theta(i) \neq i$.
- Mark a vertex i as white if $\theta(e_i) = e_i$.
- Mark a vertex i as black if $\theta(e_i) = -e_i$.

This is the *Vogan diagram* associated to the Dynkin diagram. Note that $e_i \in P$ is a non-compact root.

Exercise 11.1. Showing the following:

1. The signature of the Killing form of g_θ is $(\dim \mathfrak{p}, \dim \mathfrak{k})$. Moreover, the Killing form is negative definite if and only if $\theta = 1$, i.e. $\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{g}^c$.
2. For a split real form, $\dim \mathfrak{k} = |R_+|$.
3. Show that for any real form in a compact inner class, $\text{rank}(\mathfrak{k}) = \text{rank}(\mathfrak{g})$.

11.2 Real Forms of Classical Lie Algebras

Example 11.0.1. We have the following real forms of the classical Lie algebras:

1. Type A_{n-1} , compact inner class.

Let θ be the inner automorphism element of $\text{PSU}(n)$ of order 2. Let $g \in \text{U}(n)$ such that $g^2 = 1$. Then $\theta(x) = gxg^{-1}$, so $g = \text{id}_p \otimes (-\text{id}_q)$ with $p + q = n$. Thus

$$\mathfrak{g}_\theta = \mathfrak{su}(p, q) \quad \text{and} \quad \mathfrak{k} = \mathfrak{gl}_p \oplus \mathfrak{sl}_q.$$

For $n = 2$, we have $\mathfrak{su}(2)$ and $\mathfrak{su}(1, 1)$, with $\mathfrak{k} = \mathfrak{gl}_1$.

2. Type A_{n-1} , split inner class.

If n is odd (so all vertices are divided into connected pairs), then

$$\mathfrak{g}_\theta = \mathfrak{sl}_n(\mathbb{R}).$$

If n is even, then there is 1 stable vertex (which is either black or white). In these cases we either have $\mathfrak{k} = \mathfrak{sp}_{2k}$ (in which case $\mathfrak{g}_\theta = \mathfrak{sl}(k, \mathbb{H})$) or $\mathfrak{k} = \mathfrak{so}_{2k}$ (which is just the split form $\mathfrak{sl}_n(\mathbb{R})$).

3. Type B_n (i.e. $\mathfrak{so}_{2n+1}$).

Let θ be the inner automorphism of order ≤ 2 . We can write

$$\theta = \text{id}_{2p+1} \oplus (-\text{id}_{2q})$$

where $p + q = n$. The real forms are $\mathfrak{so}(2p + 1, 2q)$, with $\mathfrak{k} = \mathfrak{so}_{2p+1} \oplus \mathfrak{so}_{2q}$.

4. Type C_n .

We can have $g \in \text{Sp}_{2n}(\mathbb{C})$ such that $g^2 = 1$ or $g^2 = -1$. The adjoint compact group is

$$(\text{Sp}(2n) \cap \text{U}(n))/\pm 1.$$

If $g^2 = 1$, then the eigenspace with eigenvalue 1 has dimension $2p$, and the eigenspace for -1 has dimension $2q$ (where $p + q = n$). Assume that $p \geq q$ (otherwise take $g \mapsto -g$). Then we have

$$\mathfrak{sp}(2p, 2q) = \mathfrak{sp}_{2n} \cap \mathfrak{u}(p, q) = \mathfrak{u}(p, q, \mathbb{H}).$$

In this case, we have $\mathfrak{k} = \mathfrak{sp}_{2p} \oplus \mathfrak{sp}_{2q}$.

If $g^2 = -1$, then $\mathbb{C}^{2n} = V(i) \oplus V(-i)$. In this case, $\mathfrak{k} = \mathfrak{gl}_n(\mathbb{C})$, as for any $(w, w) = w \cdot \bar{w}$ in $\mathbb{C}^n$,

$$\mathrm{Im}(w, w) = i \mathrm{Im}(w \wedge \bar{w})$$

defines a symplectic form on $\mathbb{R}^{2n}$. Thus we can view $U(n) \subseteq \mathrm{Sp}_{2n}(\mathbb{R})$.

5. Type D_n , compact inner class.

In this case, θ is given by $g \in \mathrm{SO}(2n)$ with $g^2 = \pm 1$.

If $g^2 = 1$, then $\mathbb{C}^{2n} = V(1) \oplus V(-1)$ (where $\dim V(1) = 2p$ and $\dim V(-1) = 2q$ with $p + q = n$). Note that $\det(g) = 1$, so the eigenspaces are even-dimensional. Then

$$\mathfrak{g}_\theta = \mathfrak{so}(2p, 2q) \quad \text{and} \quad \mathfrak{k} = \mathfrak{so}(2p) \oplus \mathfrak{so}(2q).$$

If $g^2 = -1$, then $\mathbb{C}^{2n} = V(i) \oplus V(-i)$, so $\mathfrak{k} = \mathfrak{gl}_n(\mathbb{C})$. In this case, we have

$$\mathfrak{g}_\theta = \mathfrak{so}^*(2n),$$

which is known as the *quaternionic orthogonal Lie algebra*.

6. Type D_n , the other inner class.

In this case, θ is given by $g \in \mathrm{O}(2n)$ with $\det(g) = -1$ and $g^2 = \pm 1$.

Note that if $g^2 = -1$, then $\det(g) = 1$, which is a contradiction. So we can only have $g^2 = 1$. Then

$$\mathbb{C}^{2n} = V(1) \oplus V(-1),$$

where $\dim V(1) = 2p + 1$ and $\dim V(-1) = 2q + 1$. Here $\mathfrak{k} = \mathfrak{so}(2p + 1) \oplus \mathfrak{so}(2q + 1)$.

11.3 More on Compact Groups

Exercise 11.2. Show that if K^c is a compact Lie group, then $\mathfrak{k} = \mathrm{Lie}_{\mathbb{C}}(K^c)$ is a reductive Lie algebra.

Example 11.0.2. Let $G_{\mathrm{ad}} = \mathrm{Aut}(\mathfrak{g})^0$ for a semisimple Lie algebra $\mathfrak{g}$, and let G_{ad}^c be its compact form. Consider the following product:

$$(S^1)^r \times G_{\mathrm{ad}}^c.$$

We will see that any Lie algebra of a compact group is isomorphic to a Lie algebra of such a product. We can also consider covering spaces, i.e. what is $\pi_1(G_{\mathrm{ad}}^c)$?

Lecture 12

Feb. 23 — Classifications of Lie Groups

12.1 Classification of Compact Lie Groups

Remark. Let $\mathfrak{g}$ be semisimple and G the corresponding simply connected Lie group (which is the universal cover for $G_{\text{ad}} = \text{Aut}(\mathfrak{g})^0$). Define

$$Z = \ker(G \rightarrow G_{\text{ad}}) = \pi_1(G_{\text{ad}}).$$

Recall that the finite-dimensional representations of G are in one-to-one correspondence with the finite-dimensional representations of $\mathfrak{g}$, which (the irreducible ones) are given by $\{L_\lambda\}$ for $\lambda \in P_+$. Then Z acts as $\chi_\lambda : Z \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^\times$ on every L_λ , and $\chi_\lambda \chi_\mu = \chi_{\lambda+\mu}$. Note that

$$\chi : P \longrightarrow \text{Hom}(Z, \mathbb{C}^\times),$$

and $\chi_\theta = 1$ (where θ is the longest root) as Z acts trivially on the adjoint representation.

Exercise 12.1. If $\lambda(h_i)$ is sufficiently large, then show that for all $\alpha \in \mathfrak{g}$ we have

$$L_{\lambda+\alpha} \subseteq L_\lambda \otimes \mathfrak{g},$$

so in particular, $\chi_{\lambda+\alpha} = \chi_\lambda$, i.e. $\chi_\alpha = 1$.

Remark. We can define maps $P/Q \rightarrow \text{Hom}(Z, \mathbb{C}^\times)$ and $Z \rightarrow P^\vee/Q^\vee$ (and similarly for $G_{\text{ad}}^c, G^c, Z^c$).

Proposition 12.1. *A representation L_λ of $\mathfrak{g}$ of highest weight $\lambda \in P_+$ lifts to a representation of G_{ad} (equivalently, of G_{ad}^c) if and only if $\lambda \in P_+ \cap Q$.*

Proof. We have shown if $\lambda \in P_+ \cap Q$, then L_λ lifts. The converse follows from Proposition 12.2. $\square$

Proposition 12.2. *If V is a faithful finite-dimensional representation of a compact Lie group, then any irrep Y is contained in $V^{\otimes n} \otimes (V^*)^{\otimes m}$ for some n, m .*

Lemma 12.1. *If X is a compact manifold, then $\pi_1(X)$ is finitely generated.*

Proof. Cover X with balls around each point, by the compactness of X there is a finite subcover. Let $x_1, \dots, x_n$ be the centers of the finitely many balls, and create a graph G by connecting x_i . Then there is a surjection $\pi_1(G) \rightarrow \pi_1(X)$, and $\pi_1(G)$ is finitely generated. $\square$

Theorem 12.1. *Let $\mathfrak{g}$ be a semisimple complex Lie algebra and G_{ad}^c the corresponding adjoint compact group. Then $\pi_1(G_{\text{ad}}^c) = P^\vee/Q^\vee$. In particular, the universal cover of G_{ad}^c is a compact Lie group.*

Proof. Let G_*^c be a finite cover of G_{ad}^c and define

$$Z_{G_{\text{ad}}^c} = \ker(G_*^c \rightarrow G_{\text{ad}}^c) \subseteq G_*^c.$$

A finite-dimensional irrep is classified by $P_+(G_*^c) \subseteq P_+$ with $P_+ \cap Q \subseteq P_+(G_*^c)$. Let $P(G_*^c) \subseteq P$ be the lattice generated by $P_+(G_*^c)$, and consider the character χ_λ for the action of $Z_{G_{\text{ad}}^c}$ on L_λ (an irrep of G_*^c). Then χ gives a map

$$\xi : P(G_*^c)/Q \longrightarrow Z_{G_{\text{ad}}^c}^\vee = \text{Hom}(Z_{G_{\text{ad}}^c}, \mathbb{C}^\times).$$

Since G_*^c is compact, by the Peter-Weyl theorem ξ is surjective. It just remains to show that $\pi_1(G_{\text{ad}}^c)$ is finite. Let $G_*^c = G^c$, the universal cover. Then $P(G_*^c) = P$, so $P/Q \cong Z^\vee$, and thus

$$Z = \pi_1(G_{\text{ad}}^c) \cong P^\vee/Q^\vee.$$

By Lemma 12.1, $\pi_1(G_{\text{ad}}^c)$ is finitely generated, and it is also abelian. Take a subgroup of finite index N and take G_*^c to be the corresponding cover. Then we have

$$N = |Z_{G_*^c}| \leq |P(G_*^c)/Q| \leq |P/Q|,$$

which for abelian groups implies that the group is finite. $\square$

Corollary 12.1.1. *We have the following:*

1. *If $\mathfrak{g}$ is a semisimple complex Lie algebra, then the simply connected Lie group G^c corresponding to the Lie algebra $\mathfrak{g}^c$ is compact and its center is $P^\vee/Q^\vee$, which is the same as $\pi_1(G_{\text{ad}}^c)$.*
2. *Let $\Gamma \subseteq P^\vee/Q^\vee$. Then the irreps of G/Γ are the L_λ such that λ defines the trivial character of Γ .*
3. *Let G_i^c be compact Lie groups corresponding to simple Lie algebras $\mathfrak{g}_i$, and let $\mathfrak{g} = \bigoplus_{i=1}^n \mathfrak{g}_i$. Then any connected Lie group with Lie algebra $\mathfrak{g}^c$ is compact and of the form*

$$\left(\prod_{i=1}^n G_i^c \right) / Z,$$

where $Z = \pi_1(G^c)$ is a subgroup of $\prod_i Z_i$ for $Z_i = P_i^\vee/Q_i^\vee$ (the center of G_i^c). Moreover, every semisimple connected compact Lie group has this form.

Example 12.0.1. Let $G_*^c = \text{SO}(4, \mathbb{R})$. Then $G_{\text{ad}}^c = \text{SO}(3, \mathbb{R}) \times \text{SO}(3, \mathbb{R})$ and $G^c = \text{SU}(2) \times \text{SU}(2)$, and

$$\text{SO}(4, \mathbb{R}) = (\text{SU}(2) \times \text{SU}(2)) / \{\pm(1, 1)\}.$$

Example 12.0.2. Let $G_*^c = \text{SO}(4, \mathbb{C})$. Then $G = \text{SL}(2, \mathbb{C}) \times \text{SL}(2, \mathbb{C}) = \text{Spin}(4)$, and

$$\text{SO}(4, \mathbb{C}) = (\text{SL}(2, \mathbb{C}) \times \text{SL}(2, \mathbb{C})) / \{\pm(1, 1)\}.$$

In this case, $G_{\text{ad}} = \text{PSL}(2, \mathbb{C}) \times \text{PSL}(2, \mathbb{C})$.

Corollary 12.1.2. *Any connected compact Lie group with Lie algebra of the form $\mathfrak{g}^c \oplus \mathfrak{a}$ with $\mathfrak{a}$ abelian is a quotient of $T \times C$ by a finite central subgroup, where $T = (S^1)^m$ and C is compact, semisimple, and simply connected.*

12.2 Polar Decomposition

Remark. Consider $G_{\text{ad}, \theta} \subseteq G_{\text{ad}}$ corresponding to $\mathfrak{g}_\theta \subseteq \mathfrak{g}$. Note that $G_{\text{ad}, \theta}$ is a closed subgroup, but it may be disconnected (e.g. if $\mathfrak{g}_\theta = \mathfrak{sl}(2, \mathbb{R}) \subseteq \mathfrak{sl}(2, \mathbb{C})$, then $G_{\text{ad}} = \text{PGL}_2(\mathbb{C})$ and $G_{\text{ad}, \theta} = \text{PGL}_2(\mathbb{R})$, which is disconnected as $\det : \text{GL}_2(\mathbb{R}) \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \setminus \{0\}$ and $\mathbb{R} \setminus \{0\}$ is disconnected; but $\mathbb{C} \setminus \{0\}$ is connected).

Now let $K^c \subseteq G_{\text{ad},\theta}$ be the subgroup of elements acting on $\mathfrak{g}$ by unitary operators, i.e. K^c is the fixed points of ω_θ . Note that K^c is a closed but possibly disconnected subgroup. Let $\text{Lie}(K^c) = \mathfrak{k}^c$, and note that K^c is compact. Let $P_\theta = \exp(\mathfrak{p}_\theta) \subseteq G_{\text{ad},\theta}$, where $\mathfrak{p}_\theta = i\mathfrak{p}^c$ (note that P_θ need not be a subgroup). Now P_θ acts on $\mathfrak{g}$ by Hermitian operators, so we get a diffeomorphism

$$\exp : \mathfrak{p}_\theta \rightarrow P_\theta,$$

thus P_θ is a closed embedded submanifold in $G_{\text{ad},\theta}$.

Theorem 12.2 (Polar decomposition). *The multiplication $K^c \times P_\theta \rightarrow G_{\text{ad},\theta}$ is a diffeomorphism, hence*

$$G_{\text{ad},\theta} \cong K^c \times \mathbb{R}^{\dim \mathfrak{p}}$$

as manifolds. In particular, $G_{\text{ad},\theta}$ is homotopy equivalent to K^c .

Proof. By the polar decomposition for matrices, any invertible matrix A can be written as $A = U_A R_A$, where U_A is unitary and R_A is positive Hermitian. Explicitly, we have

$$R_A = (A^\dagger A)^{1/2} \quad \text{and} \quad U_A = A(A^\dagger A)^{-1/2}.$$

Let $g \in G_{\text{ad},\theta} \subseteq \text{Aut}(\mathfrak{g}) \subseteq \text{GL}(\mathfrak{g})$. Note that $g^\dagger g$ is an automorphism of $\mathfrak{g}$ with positive eigenvalues, so $(g^\dagger g)^{1/2} = R_g \in P_\theta$, the positive self-adjoint elements. Since U_g is unitary, it has to belong to K^c . Thus we have constructed an inverse map to μ . $\square$

Corollary 12.2.1. *We have $G_{\text{ad}} \cong G^{\text{ad}} \times \mathbb{P}$, where $\mathbb{P}$ is the set of elements acting on $\mathfrak{g}$ by positive Hermitian operators. In particular, $\pi_1(G_{\text{ad}}) = \pi_1(G_{\text{ad}}^c) = P^\vee / Q^\vee$.*

Corollary 12.2.2. *If G is a semisimple complex Lie group, then the center Z of G is contained in G^c , hence Z coincides with the center Z^c of G^c . Thus the restriction of finite-dimensional representations from G to G^c defines an equivalence of categories.*

Remark. By considering coverings, the polar decomposition also applies to the real form $G_\theta \subseteq G$ of any connected complex semisimple Lie group G . However, note that G_θ need not be simply connected even if G is (e.g. for $G = \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{C})$ we have $G_\theta = \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{R}) \cong \text{SO}(2) \cong S^1$, so $\pi_1(G_\theta) \cong \mathbb{Z}$).

Example 12.0.3. We have the following:

1. If $G = \text{SL}_n(\mathbb{C})$, then $K^c = \text{SU}(n)$ and P is the set of positive Hermitian matrices of determinant 1.
2. If $G_\theta = \text{SL}_n(\mathbb{R})$, then $K^c = \text{SO}(n)$ and P_θ is the positive symmetric matrices of determinant 1.

Lecture 13

Feb. 25 — Maximal Tori

13.1 Classification of Reductive Lie Groups

Definition 13.1. A connected complex Lie group G is *reductive* if it has the form

$$((\mathbb{C}^\times)^r \times G_{\text{ss}})/Z,$$

where G_{ss} is semisimple and Z is a finite central subgroup. A complex Lie group G is called *reductive* if G^0 is reductive and G/G_0 is finite.

Example 13.1.1. Recall that $\text{GL}_n(\mathbb{C}) = (\mathbb{C}^\times \times \text{SL}_n(\mathbb{C}))/\mu_n$, hence $\text{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$ is reductive.

Remark. With this definition, a simply connected complex Lie group with reductive Lie algebras is not necessarily reductive (e.g. $\mathbb{C}$).

Remark. Given $G = ((\mathbb{C}^\times)^r \times G_{\text{ss}})/Z$, we have $Z \subseteq (S^1)^r \times G_{\text{ss}} \subseteq (\mathbb{C}^\times)^r \times G_{\text{ss}}$. Then

$$G^c = ((S^1)^r \times G_{\text{ss}}^c)/Z \subseteq G.$$

Recall that restriction from G to G^c defines an equivalence of categories between their representations, so the representations of G are completely reducible and the irreps are characterized by

$$(n_1, \dots, n_r, \lambda), \quad \lambda \in P_+(G_{\text{ss}}), \quad n_i \in \mathbb{Z}.$$

Thus we have the characterize the trivial character of Z .

Definition 13.2. A connected Lie group G is called *linear* if it can be realized as a subgroup of $\text{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$ (or $\text{GL}_n(\mathbb{R})$) for some n .

Remark. Any complex semisimple Lie group can be realized as a linear one, but this is not true for real Lie groups (e.g. the universal cover of $\text{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$).

Proposition 13.1. Suppose $\mathfrak{g}_\theta$ is a real form of a semisimple Lie algebra $\mathfrak{g}$, and let G be the connected complex Lie group corresponding to $\mathfrak{g}$. Define $G_\theta = G^{\omega_\theta}$. Then G_θ and G_θ^0 are linear Lie groups, and every connected real semisimple Lie group is of the form G_θ^0 for some $\mathfrak{g}_\theta$.

13.2 Maximal Tori

Remark. Let $\mathfrak{g}$ be a complex semisimple Lie algebra and $\mathfrak{g}^c$ its compact form. Let G be the corresponding connected Lie group and G^c its compact part. Let $\mathfrak{h}^c \subseteq \mathfrak{g}^c$ be a maximal commutative Lie subalgebra. Note that $\mathfrak{h}^c \otimes_{\mathbb{R}} \mathbb{C} = \mathfrak{h} \subseteq \mathfrak{g}$, where $\mathfrak{h}$ is a Cartan subalgebra in $\mathfrak{g}$.

Remark. Recall that we have $\{(\mathfrak{h}, \Pi)\}$ (here $\mathfrak{h}$ is a Cartan subalgebra and Π the set of simple roots) are all conjugate: For any $(\mathfrak{h}, \Pi)$ and $(\mathfrak{h}', \Pi')$, there exists $g \in G$ such that

$$\text{Ad}_g(\mathfrak{h}, \Pi) = (\mathfrak{h}', \Pi').$$

The same happens for $\mathfrak{g}^c$.

Lemma 13.1. *Any two Cartan subalgebras in $\mathfrak{g}^c$ equipped with systems of simple roots are conjugate under some $g \in G^c$.*

Proof. Fix $(\mathfrak{h}^c, \Pi)$ and $((\mathfrak{h}^c)', \Pi')$. Then there exists $g \in G$ such that

$$\text{Ad}_g(\mathfrak{h}^c, \Pi) = ((\mathfrak{h}^c)', \Pi'),$$

and for $\bar{g} = \omega(g)$, we have $\text{Ad}_{\bar{g}}(\mathfrak{h}^c, \Pi) = ((\mathfrak{h}^c)', \Pi')$. Then $\bar{g}^{-1}g$ commutes with $\mathfrak{h}^c$, so it preserves Π . Now $\bar{g}h = g$ for some $h \in H = \exp(\mathfrak{h}_{\mathbb{C}}^c)$. Write $g = kp$ for some $k \in G^c$ and $p \in P$ by the polar decomposition. Then $\bar{g} = kp^{-1}$, so $kp^{-1}h = kp$, so $h = p^2$. So $p = h^{1/2}$ commutes with $\mathfrak{h}^c$ and preserves Π . Thus we can take $k \in G^c$ to be the desired element. $\square$

Definition 13.3. Given a Cartan subalgebra $\mathfrak{h}^c \subseteq \mathfrak{g}^c$, the corresponding Lie group $H^c = \exp(\mathfrak{h}^c) \subseteq G^c$ is called a *maximal torus*.

Corollary 13.0.1. *Any two maximal tori in G or G^c equipped with systems of simple roots are conjugate.*

Theorem 13.1. *Every element of a connected compact Lie group K is contained in a maximal torus, and all maximal tori are conjugate.*

Proof. We can assume K is semisimple and $K = G^c$. Let $K' \subseteq K$ be the set of elements contained in some maximal torus. Fix a maximal torus $T \subseteq K$, and define

$$\begin{aligned} f : K \times T &\longrightarrow K \\ k, t &\longmapsto ktk^{-1}. \end{aligned}$$

Clearly $\text{Im } f = K'$. Note that K' is compact, so K' is closed and hence $K \setminus K'$ is open. Note that a generic $x \in \mathfrak{g}^c$ is a regular element, i.e. its centralizer $\mathfrak{z}_x$ has $\dim \mathfrak{z}_x = \text{rank } \mathfrak{g}$. Then every regular element $g \in K$ is contained in the maximal torus $\exp(\mathfrak{z}_x)$, so the elements of $K' \setminus K$ are non-regular. Since the non-regular elements are defined by a set of polynomial equations, $K' \setminus K$ is also closed. Hence $K' \setminus K$ must be empty by connectedness. $\square$

Corollary 13.1.1. *On compact groups, the exponential map $\exp : \mathfrak{g}^c \rightarrow G^c$ is surjective.*

13.3 Semisimple and Unipotent Elements

Definition 13.4. Let G be a connected complex reductive Lie group. An element $g \in G$ is *semisimple* (resp. *unipotent*) if it acts in every finite-dimensional representation of G by semisimple (resp. unipotent, i.e. all eigenvalues are 1) operators.

Exercise 13.1. Recall that for any compact G , there is a faithful finite-dimensional representation Y . Show that $g \in G$ is semisimple (resp. unipotent) if and only if it acts on Y by a semisimple (resp. unipotent) operator.

Exercise 13.2. Show that if G is semisimple, then the exponential map defines a homeomorphism between the set of nilpotent elements in $\mathfrak{g} = \text{Lie}(G)$ and the set of unipotent elements in G .

Exercise 13.3. Let Z be the center of a connected complex reductive Lie group G .

1. Show that the homomorphism $\pi : G \rightarrow G/Z$ defines a bijection between the unipotent elements of G and G/Z .
2. Show that the set of semisimple elements of G is the preimage under π of the set of semisimple elements in G/Z .

Proposition 13.2 (Jordan decomposition). *Any $g \in G$ has a unique factorization*

$$g = g_s g_u,$$

where $g_s \in G$ is semisimple, $g_u \in G$ is unipotent, and $g_s g_u = g_u g_s$.

Proof. We can reduce to the adjoint group. Then we can decompose

$$\text{Ad}_g = su$$

uniquely on the level of matrices, where s is semisimple and u is unipotent. It then suffices to show that s, u are $\text{Ad}_{g_s}, \text{Ad}_{g_u}$ for some group elements. Fill in the details as an exercise. $\square$

13.4 Cartan Decomposition

Remark. Let G be a connected complex semisimple Lie group. Let $G_\theta \subseteq G$ be a real form, and write $G_\theta = K^c P_\theta$. Then $\mathfrak{g}_\theta = \mathfrak{k}^c \oplus \mathfrak{p}_\theta$ and $\mathfrak{g}^c = \mathfrak{k}^c \oplus \mathfrak{p}^c$ where $\mathfrak{p}_\theta = i\mathfrak{p}^c$.

Proposition 13.3. *We have the following:*

1. Let $\mathfrak{a}$ be a maximal abelian subspace in $\mathfrak{p}_\theta$. Then the centralizer $\mathfrak{z}$ of $\mathfrak{a}$ in $\mathfrak{g}^c$ has the form $\mathfrak{m} \oplus \mathfrak{a}$, where $\mathfrak{m}$ is a reductive Lie algebra in $\mathfrak{k}^c$. Moreover, $\mathfrak{t}$ is a Cartan subalgebra in $\mathfrak{m}$, $\mathfrak{t} \oplus i\mathfrak{a}$ is a Cartan subalgebra in $\mathfrak{t} \oplus \mathfrak{a}$ is a Cartan subalgebra in $\mathfrak{g}_\theta$.
2. If $a \in \mathfrak{a}$ is sufficiently generic in $\mathfrak{p}_\theta$, then the centralizer of a in $\mathfrak{p}_\theta$ is $\mathfrak{a}$.
3. For all $p \in \mathfrak{p}_\theta$, there exists $k \in K^c$ such that $\text{Ad}_k(p) \in \mathfrak{a}$.
4. All maximal subspaces of $\mathfrak{p}_\theta$ are conjugated by K^c .

Theorem 13.2 (Cartan decomposition). *Let $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}_\theta$ be a maximal abelian subspace. Let $A = \exp(\mathfrak{a}) \subseteq P_\theta \subseteq G_\theta$, which is isomorphic to $\mathbb{R}^n$ where $n = \dim \mathfrak{a}$. Then $G_\theta = K^c A K^c$.*

Remark. The decomposition in Theorem 13.2 is not unique.

Remark. For $G_\theta = \text{GL}_n(\mathbb{C})$, the Cartan decomposition is $U_1 D U_2$ where U_1, U_2 are unitary and D is diagonal with positive entries, a classical theorem of linear algebra.

Theorem 13.3 (E. Cartan). *Let G_θ be a real form of a connected semisimple complex Lie group. Then any compact subgroup L of G_θ is conjugated to a subgroup of K^c by an element of P_θ . Also, every compact subgroup of G_θ is contained in a maximal one. Therefore, all maximal compact subgroups are conjugate to each other.*

Lecture 14

Mar. 2 — Verma Modules

14.1 Integral Form of Weyl Character Formula

Theorem 14.1. *If f is a conjugation invariant continuous function on a compact connected Lie group K with maximal torus $T \subseteq K$ and Haar probability measures dk and dt , then*

$$\int_K f(k) dk = \frac{1}{|W|} \int_T f(t) |\delta(t)|^2 dt,$$

where $\delta(t) = \rho(t)^{-1} \prod_{\alpha \in R_+} (\alpha(t) - 1)$.¹

Proof. First (exercise) use the Peter-Weyl theorem to show that the characters form a dense set in the space of conjugation invariant functions. So it suffices to show the formula for f a character. Then

$$\int_K \chi_\lambda(k) dk = \delta_{\lambda,0}$$

is the left-hand side by the orthogonality of characters. Now write

$$\chi_\lambda(t) = \frac{\sum_{w \in W} \varepsilon(w) t^{w(\lambda+\rho)}}{\Delta}, \quad \Delta = \sum_{w \in W} \varepsilon(w) t^{w(\rho)} = t^{-\rho} \prod_{\alpha \in R_+} (t^\alpha - 1) = \rho(t)^{-1} \prod_{\alpha \in R_+} (\alpha(t) - 1),$$

so $\Delta = \delta(t)$. Here $\varepsilon(w) = (-1)^{\ell(w)}$ is the sign of w . Then we get

$$\frac{1}{|W|} \int_T \chi_\lambda(t) \overline{\chi_\mu(t)} |\delta(t)|^2 dt = \frac{1}{|W|} \int_T \sum_{w \in W} \varepsilon(w) t^{w(\lambda+\rho)} \sum_{w' \in W} \varepsilon(w') t^{-w'(\mu+\rho)} dt$$

This is equal to $\delta_{\lambda,\mu}$ by the orthogonality of characters, so we get the formula. $\square$

Remark. If $T \cong \mathbb{R}^r / \Lambda$ where $\Lambda \cong \mathbb{Z}^r$ and $\mathcal{F}$ is a fundamental domain for T , then $H = \sum_{i=1}^r x_i e_i$ and

$$dt = \frac{dx_1 \dots dx_r}{\text{vol}(\mathcal{F})}.$$

For $e^{i\theta_j}$ on $U(n)$, this is given by $(d\theta_1 \dots d\theta_n) / (2\pi)^n$.

Exercise 14.1. Let f be a conjugation invariant function on $U(n)$. Show that

$$\int_{U(n)} f(k) dk = \frac{1}{(2\pi)^n n!} \int_{|z_1|=\dots=|z_n|=1} f(\text{diag}(z_1, \dots, z_n)) \prod_{m < j} |z_m - z_j|^2 d\theta_1 \dots d\theta_n, \quad z_j = e^{i\theta_j}.$$

¹Recall that if $\alpha \in R_+$ and $e^H = t$ for $H \in \mathfrak{t} = \text{Lie } T$, then we denote $e^{\alpha(H)} = t^\alpha = \alpha(t)$.

14.2 More on Verma Modules

Remark. Let $\mathfrak{g}$ be a complex semisimple Lie algebra and $\mathfrak{h} \subseteq \mathfrak{g}$ a Cartan subalgebra. Let $\lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*$ and M_λ the Verma module of highest weight λ , i.e. it is generated by one vector v_λ with

$$e_i v_\lambda = 0 \quad \text{and} \quad h(v_\lambda) = \lambda(h)v_\lambda$$

for $1 \leq i \leq r$. Note that $M_\lambda = \text{Ind}_{\mathfrak{h} \oplus \mathfrak{n}^+} \mathbb{C}_\lambda$, where $\mathbb{C}_\lambda$ is the one-dimensional representation for $\mathfrak{h} \oplus \mathfrak{n}^+$ defined by the above actions. Note that M_λ is irreducible for generic λ . In these cases,

$$L_\lambda = M_\lambda / I_\lambda$$

is irreducible, where I_λ is the maximal proper submodule of M_λ . Note that exchanging e_i and f_i in the above definitions gives the lowest weight Verma modules.

There is a unique symmetric bilinear form on M_λ satisfying the contravariance property:

$$\langle v_\lambda, v_\lambda \rangle = 1 \quad \text{and} \quad \langle e_i u, w \rangle = \langle u, f_i w \rangle$$

for $u, w \in M_\lambda$. This form is known as the *Shapovalov form*, and its kernel is precisely I_λ . Note that if ω is the *Chevalley involution* given by $\omega(e_i) = -f_i$, $\omega(f_i) = -e_i$, and $\omega(h_i) = -h_i$, then

$$\langle xu, v \rangle = -\langle u, \omega(x)v \rangle$$

is the contravariance property from above.

Let $V = \bigoplus V^\mu$ be the weight decomposition (note that the weight spaces are finite-dimensional). Then the V^μ and V^ν are orthogonal with respect to the Shapovalov form for $\mu \neq \nu$. Let

$$V^* = \bigoplus_{\lambda} (V^\lambda)^*$$

be the *restricted dual* of V , and let $\text{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(V_1, V_2)$ be the space of all linear maps.

Proposition 14.1. *If M_λ is irreducible, then its restricted dual is the lowest weight Verma module with lowest weight $-\lambda$.*

Definition 14.1. Define V^c to be the restricted dual of V with action of $\mathfrak{g}$ twisted by ω :

$$\langle xu^c, v \rangle = -\langle u^c, \omega(x)v \rangle, \quad u^c \in V^c, v \in V, x \in \mathfrak{g}.$$

Naturally, V^c has the same weight subspaces as V . We call M_λ^c the *contragredient Verma module*.

Remark. There is a unique $M_\lambda \rightarrow M_\lambda^c$ with image L_λ , and combining it with the pairing above gives

$$M_\lambda^c \otimes M_\lambda \longrightarrow \mathbb{C},$$

which is exactly the Shapovalov form.

Theorem 14.2. *The Verma module is irreducible if and only if the following condition is satisfied: For any $\alpha \in R_+$, we have $\langle \lambda + \rho, \alpha^\vee \rangle \notin \mathbb{N}$.*

Definition 14.2. We will call λ *generic* if for all $\alpha \in R_+$, we have $\langle \lambda, \alpha^\vee \rangle \notin \mathbb{Z}$.

Theorem 14.3. *We have the following:*

1. The module L_λ is irreducible if and only if $\lambda \in P^+$.
2. The representations L_λ for $\lambda \in P^+$ are pairwise non-isomorphic, and any finite-dimensional irrep is isomorphic to one of them.
3. If $\lambda = \sum n_i \omega_i$ with $n_i \in \mathbb{Z}$, then L_λ is generated by v_λ and the action of $\mathfrak{g}$ on v_λ with the constraints $f_i^{n_i+1} v_\lambda = 0$ for $i = 1, \dots, r$. Moreover, we have $L_\lambda^* \cong L_{-w_0(\lambda)}$.

Proposition 14.2. The category $C(\mathfrak{g})$ of finite-dimensional representations is semisimple, i.e. every module V is isomorphic to a direct sum of simple modules L_λ for $\lambda \in P^+$. Moreover, the map

$$\Phi \longmapsto \Phi(v_\lambda)$$

identifies the multiplicity space $\text{Hom}_{\mathfrak{g}}(L_\lambda, V)$ for $\lambda \in P^+$ with the space

$$(V^\lambda)^{\mathfrak{n}^+} = \{v \in V^\lambda : e_i v = 0\}$$

of singular vectors of weight λ .

14.3 Maximal Roots and the Casimir Operator

Remark. Recall that the *maximal root* θ is the highest weight in the adjoint representation.

Proposition 14.3. The maximal root is uniquely determined by the following conditions: For all $\alpha \in R$, we have $\theta - \alpha \in Q^+$.

Remark. We normalize the pairing so that $(\theta, \theta) = 2$. Let

- $\theta = \sum_i h_i \alpha_i$,
- $h = 1 + \sum_i h_i$,
- $h_i^\vee = h_i(\alpha_i, \alpha_i)/2$ (these are the coefficients of the expansion of $\tilde{\theta}^\vee$),
- $h^\vee = 1 + \sum_i h_i^\vee = (\rho, \theta) + 1$ (this is the dual Coxeter number).

For root systems of type A, D, E, we have $h = h^\vee$.

Remark. Recall that $C = \sum x_i x^i$ is the *Casimir operator*, where $\{x^i\}$ is the dual basis for x_i . Then

$$\Omega = \sum (x_i \otimes x^i)$$

does not depend on the choice of basis, and the value of C on any irreducible highest weight module L_λ is given by $(\lambda, \lambda + 2\rho)$ (and for the lowest weight $L_{-\mu}$ by $(\mu, \mu + 2\rho)$). The value of C in the adjoint representation is given by $2h^\vee$.

Exercise 14.2. Show that in a tensor product of two representations, the action of $\mathfrak{g}$ commutes with Ω .

Proposition 14.4. We have

$$\Omega|_{V_\lambda \otimes V_\mu \otimes V_\nu} = \frac{(\lambda, \lambda + 2\rho) - (\mu, \mu + 2\rho) - (\nu, \nu + 2\rho)}{2}.$$

Proof. The proof relies on the identity

$$\Omega = \frac{1}{2}(\Delta(C) - c \otimes 1 - 1 \otimes c),$$

where $\Delta : U(\mathfrak{g}) \rightarrow U(\mathfrak{g}) \otimes U(\mathfrak{g})$ is given by $x \mapsto x \otimes 1 + 1 \otimes x$. Note that $(\Delta \otimes I)\Delta = (I \otimes \Delta)\Delta$. $\square$

14.4 Affine Lie Algebras

Remark. Consider a manifold M and a 1-form J satisfying $d(*J) = 0$. The 1-form J takes values in a Lie algebra, and we have

$$[J^a(x), J^b(y)] = f^{a,b,c} J^c(x) \delta(x - y),$$

where the $f^{a,b,c}$ are the structure constants of the Lie algebra. These are called *current algebras*, see the book by J. Mickelson for more details (e.g. for maps $S^3 \rightarrow \mathfrak{g}$).

We will consider the case where M is 2-dimensional. Then the conservation property becomes

$$\partial_{\bar{z}} J_z + \partial_z J_{\bar{z}} = 0.$$

In some cases, this can be separated, so that $\partial_{\bar{z}} J_z = 0$, i.e. J_z is holomorphic. Then we can write

$$J_z = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} J_n z^{-n-1}.$$

The J_n in this expansion are called *modes* (one can think of this as some kind of wave expansion). Then the commutation relations become (with some correction term)

$$[J_n^a, J_m^b] = f^{a,b,c} J_{n+m}^c.$$

Remark. One can think of the modes above as loops. The *loop algebra* is

$$L\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{g} \otimes \mathbb{C}[t, t^{-1}].$$

One can also think of them as maps $S^1 \rightarrow \mathfrak{g}$. The commutation relations for $L\mathfrak{g}$ are

$$[x \otimes P, y \otimes Q] = [x, y] \otimes PQ,$$

so that $x \otimes t^n = x[n]$ has commutation relations

$$[x[n], y[m]] = [x, y][m + n].$$

This algebra has a unique nontrivial central extension, i.e. a short exact sequence of Lie algebras

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathfrak{g} \longrightarrow \widehat{\mathfrak{g}} \longrightarrow \mathbb{C}c \longrightarrow 0$$

Here $\mathfrak{g}$ is a simple Lie algebra. Then on $\widehat{\mathfrak{g}}$, we have $[c, x \otimes P] = 0$ for $P \in \mathbb{C}[t, t^{-1}]$ and

$$[x \otimes P, y \otimes Q] = [x, y] \otimes PQ + c \frac{(x, y)}{2\pi i} \oint_{|t|=1} Q dP,$$

which gives the commutation relation

$$[x[n], y[m]] = [x, y][m + n] + n\delta_{n, -m}(x, y)c.$$

Lecture 15

Mar. 4 — Affine Lie Algebras

15.1 Affine Lie Algebras, Continued

Remark. We can extend $\widehat{\mathfrak{g}}$ again by the grading operator $d = t \frac{d}{dt}$ to get $\widetilde{\mathfrak{g}} = \widehat{\mathfrak{g}} \oplus \mathbb{C}d$, where

$$[d, x[n]] = nx[n] \quad \text{and} \quad [d, x \otimes P] = x \otimes t \frac{d}{dt} P.$$

We can also define a nondegenerate form on $\widehat{\mathfrak{g}}$ by

$$(x \otimes P, y \otimes Q) = \frac{(x, y)}{2\pi i} \oint_{|t|=1} PQ \frac{dt}{t},$$

and on $\widetilde{\mathfrak{g}}$ by $(c, d) = 1$ and $(c, c) = (d, d) = (c, x \otimes P) = (d, x \otimes P) = 0$.

Definition 15.1. Define $\widehat{\mathfrak{h}} \subseteq \widehat{\mathfrak{g}}$ by $\widehat{\mathfrak{h}} = \mathfrak{h} \oplus \mathbb{C}c$ and $\widetilde{\mathfrak{h}} \subseteq \widetilde{\mathfrak{g}}$ by $\widetilde{\mathfrak{h}} = \widehat{\mathfrak{h}} \oplus \mathbb{C}d$, these are Cartan subalgebras. Their duals are

$$\widehat{\mathfrak{h}}^* = \mathfrak{h}^* \oplus \mathbb{C}\Lambda_0 \quad \text{and} \quad \widetilde{\mathfrak{h}}^* = \mathfrak{h}^* \oplus \mathbb{C}\Lambda_0 \oplus \mathbb{C}\delta,$$

where $\Lambda_0(c) = 1$, $\Lambda_0(d) = \Lambda_0(h) = 0$ for $h \in \mathfrak{h}$, and $\delta(d) = 1$, $\delta(c) = \delta(h) = 0$ for $h \in \mathfrak{h}$.

Remark. We can write

$$\widetilde{\mathfrak{g}} = \widetilde{\mathfrak{h}} \oplus \bigoplus_{\gamma \in \widehat{R}} \widehat{\mathfrak{g}}^\gamma,$$

where $\widehat{\mathfrak{g}}^\gamma = \{x \in \widehat{\mathfrak{g}} : [h, x] = \gamma(h)x \text{ for } h \in \widetilde{\mathfrak{h}}\}$ and $\widehat{R} = \{\alpha + n\delta : \alpha \in R \sqcup \{0\}, n \in \mathbb{Z} \text{ not both } 0\}$. Then

$$\widetilde{\mathfrak{g}}^{\alpha+n\delta} = \mathfrak{g}^\alpha \otimes t^n \quad \text{and} \quad \widetilde{\mathfrak{g}}^{n\delta} = \mathfrak{h} \otimes t^n,$$

with $\alpha \in R$, $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, and $n \in \mathbb{Z} \setminus \{0\}$, respectively. We can choose a polarization

$$\widehat{R} = \widehat{R}_+ \sqcup \widehat{R}_-, \quad \widehat{R}_+ = \{\alpha + n\delta : n > 0 \text{ or } n = 0, \alpha \in R_+\},$$

where as usual $\widehat{R}_- = -\widehat{R}_+$. The simple roots in $\widehat{R}_+$ are the ones which cannot be represented as a nontrivial sum of positive roots. Let $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_r$ be the simple roots of $\mathfrak{g}$ and

$$\alpha_0 = \delta - \theta,$$

where θ is the highest root. Then we can define $\widehat{\mathfrak{n}}^\pm = \mathfrak{n}^\pm \oplus (\mathfrak{g} \otimes t^{\pm 1} \mathbb{C}[t^{\pm 1}])$ and write

$$\widetilde{\mathfrak{g}} = \widehat{\mathfrak{n}}^+ \oplus \widehat{\mathfrak{h}} \oplus \widehat{\mathfrak{n}}^-.$$

The root lattices $\widehat{Q} = \bigoplus_{i=0}^r \mathbb{Z}\alpha_i$ and $\widehat{Q}^+ = \sum_{i=0}^r \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}\alpha_i$. We can define the coroot

$$\alpha_0^\vee = \frac{2h_{\alpha_0}}{(\alpha_0, \alpha_0)} = h_{\alpha_0} = c - \theta^\vee.$$

Then we can define the weight lattice by $\widehat{P} = \langle \Lambda \in \widetilde{\mathfrak{h}}^* : \Lambda(\alpha_i^\vee) \in \mathbb{Z} \rangle = P \oplus \mathbb{Z}\Lambda_0 \oplus \mathbb{C}\delta$, and

$$\widehat{P}^+ = \{ \Lambda \in \widetilde{\mathfrak{h}}^* : \Lambda(\alpha_i^\vee) \in \mathbb{Z}_+ \} = \{ \Lambda = \lambda + k\Lambda_0 - \Delta\delta : \lambda \in P^+, k \in \mathbb{Z}_+, \Delta \in \mathbb{C}, \langle \lambda, \theta^\vee \rangle \leq k \}.$$

From this we get a Cartan matrix $A = \{a_{i,j}\}_{i,j=0}^r$.

15.2 Generalized Cartan Matrices

Remark. A *generalized Cartan matrix* is a matrix $A = \{a_{i,j}\}_{i,j=0}^r$ satisfying

1. $a_{i,i} = 2$ for all i ,
2. $a_{i,j} \leq 0$ for $i \neq j$,
3. $a_{i,j} = 0$ if and only if $a_{j,i} = 0$.

Definition 15.2. Let A be a generalized Cartan matrix. The *Kac-Moody algebra* $\mathfrak{g}(A)$ is the Lie algebra generated by elements $\{e_i, h_i, f_i\}$ together with the standard Serre relations.

Theorem 15.1. The Lie algebra $\widehat{\mathfrak{g}}$ is the Kac-Moody algebra associated with the Cartan matrix which we constructed above.

Remark. We have $e_0 \in \mathfrak{g}^{-\theta} \otimes t$, $f_0 \in \mathfrak{g}^{\theta} \otimes t^{-1}$, $(e_0, f_0) = 1$, and $h_0 = [e_0, f_0] = c - \theta^\vee$.

Remark. Let A be a generalized Cartan matrix and assume that it is symmetrizable, i.e. there exist d_i such that $d_i a_{i,j} = d_j a_{j,i}$. Then we can define an inner product

$$(h_i, h_j) := \frac{a_{i,j}}{d_i}$$

on the Cartan subalgebra. Let Z be the kernel of this inner product. Let

$$\mathfrak{g}_e(A) = \mathfrak{g}(A) \oplus Z^*$$

with commutation relations $[z_1, z_2] = [z_1, h] = 0$, $[z, e_j] = z(\alpha_j)e_j$, and $[z, f_j] = -z(\alpha_j)f_j$. Then

$$\langle h_i, h_j \rangle = \frac{a_{i,j}}{d_j}, \quad \langle h, z \rangle = z(h), \quad \langle z_1, z_2 \rangle = 0$$

defines a nondegenerate pairing on $\mathfrak{g}_e(A)$.

15.3 Verma Modules and Weyl Modules

Definition 15.3. Let $\Lambda \in \widetilde{\mathfrak{h}}^*$. The *Verma module* corresponding to Λ is

$$M_\Lambda = \text{Ind}_{\widehat{\mathfrak{h}} \oplus \widehat{\mathfrak{n}}^+}^{\widehat{\mathfrak{g}}} \mathbb{C}_\Lambda$$

where $\mathbb{C}_\Lambda$ is the 1-dimensional representation of $\widehat{\mathfrak{h}} \oplus \widehat{\mathfrak{n}}^+$. Let v_Λ be the basis vector, with $h v_\Lambda = \Lambda(h)v_\Lambda$.

Remark. We have a weight decomposition given by

$$M_\Lambda = \bigoplus_{m \in \Lambda - \hat{Q}^+} M_\Lambda^m,$$

where $\Lambda = \lambda + k\Lambda_0 - \Delta\delta$ for some $\lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*$. From the $\hat{\mathfrak{g}}$ perspective, we have

$$\Delta = \Delta(\lambda) = \frac{(\lambda, \lambda + 2\rho)}{2(k + h^\vee)}$$

(here $h^\vee$ is the dual Coxeter number). We call k the *central charge* (or *level*) of the representation. In this case, we say that a $\hat{\mathfrak{g}}$ -module V is of level k or V is a module with central charge k . We denote the corresponding Verma module M_Λ by $M_{\lambda,k}$.

The case $k = -h^\vee$ is called the *critical level*, though this generally does not happen.

Remark. The Verma module $M_{\lambda,k}$ has a natural $\mathbb{Z}$ -grading given by

$$M_{\lambda,k} = \bigoplus_{n \geq 0} M_{\lambda,k}[-n],$$

where $M_{\lambda,k}[-n]$ is naturally a $\mathfrak{g}$ -module and an eigenspace of d with eigenvalue $-n - \Delta(\lambda)$.

Example 15.3.1. We have $M_{\lambda,k}[0] = M_\lambda$, the Verma module for $\mathfrak{g}$.

Remark. Let $L_\Lambda = M_\Lambda / I_\Lambda$, where I_Λ is the maximal proper submodule of M_Λ . Then $L_{\lambda,k} := L_\Lambda$ is an irreducible module. The *Chevalley involution* $\tilde{\omega}$ is given by

$$\tilde{\omega}(d) = -d$$

and on $L\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{g} \otimes \mathbb{C}[t, t^{-1}]$ by $t \mapsto t^{-1}$. Then $\tilde{\omega}$ gives a contravariant *Shapovalov form* with kernel I_Λ .

Remark. We can construct a class of representations of $\tilde{\mathfrak{g}}$ induced from $\mathfrak{g}$ -modules. Let

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{g}}^+ = \mathfrak{g} \otimes \mathbb{C}[t] \oplus \mathbb{C}c \oplus \mathbb{C}d \subseteq \tilde{\mathfrak{g}}.$$

If V is a module for $\mathfrak{g}$, then automatically V is also a module for $\tilde{\mathfrak{g}}^+$ by letting

1. $\mathfrak{g} \otimes t\mathbb{C}[t]$ act by 0,
2. c, d act by $k, -\Delta$, respectively.

Then one can define $\text{Ind}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{g}}^+}^{\tilde{\mathfrak{g}}} V$, which is a module for $\tilde{\mathfrak{g}}$.

Example 15.3.2. Verma modules belong to this class, as we can write

$$M_{\lambda,k} = \text{Ind}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{g}}^+}^{\tilde{\mathfrak{g}}} M_\lambda$$

where d acts on M_λ by $-\Delta(\lambda)$.

Example 15.3.3. Let $V_{\lambda,k} = \text{Ind}_{\tilde{\mathfrak{g}}^+}^{\tilde{\mathfrak{g}}} L_\lambda$, where d acts as $-\Delta(\lambda)$. If $\lambda \in P_+$, we call $V_{\lambda,k}$ a *Weyl module*.

Remark. We get a contragredient Verma module by replacing ω with $\tilde{\omega}$. This gives maps $M_{\lambda,k} \rightarrow M_{\lambda,k}^c$ and $V_{\lambda,k} \rightarrow V_{\lambda,k}^c$, which are isomorphisms if $M_{\lambda,k}, V_{\lambda,k}$ are irreducible.

15.4 Integrable Representations

Theorem 15.2. *The Verma module M_Λ is irreducible if the following condition is satisfied: For every $\hat{\alpha} \in \hat{R}_+$ and $N \in \{1, 2, \dots\}$, we have $(\Lambda + \hat{\rho}, \hat{\alpha}) \neq N(\hat{\alpha}, \hat{\alpha})/2$, where $\hat{\rho} = \rho + h^\vee \Lambda_0$.*

Remark. For $(\hat{\alpha}, \hat{\alpha}) \neq 0$, the above condition becomes $(\Lambda + \hat{\rho}, \hat{\alpha}^\vee) \neq N$, which is the analogue of the simple Lie algebra case.

Remark. We call weights satisfying $(\Lambda + \hat{\rho}, \hat{\alpha}) \neq N(\hat{\alpha}, \hat{\alpha})/2$ *generic*. For generic weights, $L_\Lambda = M_\Lambda$.

Theorem 15.3. *Let $\lambda \in \mathfrak{h}^*$ and $k \in \mathbb{C}$ be such that $k \notin \mathbb{Q}\langle \alpha^\vee, \lambda \rangle + \mathbb{Q}$ for all $\alpha \in R_+$. Then the induced module $V_{\lambda, k}$ is irreducible. If this holds, we say that k is generic with respect to λ .*

Corollary 15.3.1. *If $\lambda \in P^+$ and $k \notin \mathbb{Q}$, then the Weyl module $V_{\lambda, k}$ is irreducible.*

Lecture 16

Mar. 9 —

Lecture 17

Mar. 11 —

Lecture 18

Mar. 16 — Correlation Functions

18.1 Correlation Functions

Remark. Recall that if we write $J_x(z) = J_x^+(z) - J_x^-(z)$, then

$$[J_x^\pm(z), \Phi_n^{(g)}(w)] = \frac{1}{z-w} \Phi_{xn}^g(w).$$

Then $\widehat{\Phi}^g(z) = z^{-\Delta(\mu)} \widetilde{\Phi}^g(z) = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} \Phi[n] z^{-n-\Delta}$, where $\Delta = \Delta(\lambda_1) - \Delta(\lambda_0) + \Delta(\mu)$ and

$$\Phi^g(z) : V_{\lambda_1, k} \longrightarrow V_{\lambda_0, k} \widehat{\otimes} V_\mu(z).$$

Theorem 18.1 (FR). *We have*

$$(k + h^\vee) \frac{d}{dz} \widehat{\Phi}^g(z) = \sum_{a \in B} :J_a(z) \widehat{\Phi}_{an}^g(z):.$$

Remark. Let $\widehat{\Phi}^{g_i}(z_i) : V_{\lambda_i, k} \widehat{\otimes} z^{-\Delta} V_{\mu_i}[z_i^{\pm 1}]$ and

$$\psi(z_1, \dots, z_N) = (\widehat{\Phi}^{g_1}(z_1) \otimes \dots \otimes 1) \dots (\widehat{\Phi}^{g_{N-1}}(z_{N-1}) \otimes 1) \widehat{\Phi}^{g_N}(z_N),$$

where $\psi : V_{\lambda_N, k} \rightarrow V_{\lambda_0, k} \widehat{\otimes} V_{\mu_1}(z_1) \widehat{\otimes} \dots \widehat{\otimes} V_{\mu_N}(z_N)$. Here V_{μ_i} are the lowest weight modules with lowest weight $-\mu_i$. Let $u_0 \in (V_{\lambda_0, k}[0])^* = L_{\lambda_0}^*$ and $u_{N+1} \in V_{\lambda_N, k}[0] = L_{\lambda_N}$. Then

$$\langle u_0, \psi(z_1, \dots, z_N) u_{N+1} \rangle \in V_{\mu_1} \otimes \dots \otimes V_{\mu_N}.$$

We can also treat this as lying in $z_1^{-\Delta_1} \dots z_N^{-\Delta_N} \mathbb{C}[[z_2/z_1, \dots, z_N/z_{N-1}]]$. Fix u_0 and define a V -valued function (called the *correlation function*)

$$\psi(z_1, \dots, z_N) = \langle u_0, \psi(z_1, \dots, z_N) \cdot \rangle,$$

where $V = V_{\mu_1} \otimes \dots \otimes V_{\mu_N} \otimes L_{\lambda_N}^*$. For $u_i \in V_{\mu_i}^*$, we have

$$\psi_{u_1, \dots, u_{N+1}}(z_1, \dots, z_N) = \langle u_0, \Phi_{u_1}^{g_1} \dots \Phi_{u_N}^{g_N} u_{N+1} \rangle \in \mathbb{C}.$$

Theorem 18.2. *The correlation function $\psi(z_1, \dots, z_N)$ satisfies the following system of differential equations:*

$$(k + h^\vee) \partial_{z_i} \psi = \left(\sum_{j=1, j \neq i} \frac{\Omega_{i,j}}{z_i - z_j} + \frac{\Omega_{i, N+1}}{z_i} \right) \psi,$$

where $\Omega = \sum x_i \otimes x^i$ and $A_{i,j} = (x)_i (y)_j$ for $A = x \otimes y \in \mathfrak{g} \otimes \mathfrak{g}$.

Proof. We can write

$$\begin{aligned}
& (k + h^\vee) \frac{\partial}{\partial z_i} \psi_{u_1, \dots, u_{N+1}}(z_1, \dots, z_N) \\
&= \sum_{a \in B} \langle u_0, \widehat{\Phi}_{u_1}(z_1), \dots, (J_a^+(z_i) \widehat{\Phi}_{au_i}(z_i) - \widehat{\Phi}_{au_i}(z_i) J_a^-(z_i)), \dots, \widehat{\Phi}_{u_N}(z_N) u_{N+1} \rangle \\
&= \sum_{j=1}^{i-1} \langle u_0, \widehat{\Phi}_{u_1}(z_1), \dots, [\widehat{\Phi}_{u_j}(z_j), J_a^+(z_i)], \dots, \widehat{\Phi}_{u_N}(z_N) u_{N+1} \rangle \tag{*}
\end{aligned}$$

$$+ \sum_{j=i+1}^N \langle u_0, \widehat{\Phi}_{u_1}(z_1), \dots, [\widehat{\Phi}_{u_j}(z_j), J_a^-(z_i)], \dots, \widehat{\Phi}_{u_N}(z_N) u_{N+1} \rangle \tag{**}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
& + \langle u_0, J_a^+(z_i) \widehat{\Phi}_{u_1}(z_1), \dots, \widehat{\Phi}_{au_i}(z_i), \dots, \widehat{\Phi}_{u_N}(z_N) u_{N+1} \rangle \\
& - \langle u_0, \widehat{\Phi}_{u_1}(z_1), \dots, \widehat{\Phi}_{au_i}(z_i), \dots, \widehat{\Phi}_{u_N}(z_N) J_a^-(z_i) u_{N+1} \rangle. \tag{***}
\end{aligned}$$

Now we have $J_a^-(z) u_{N+1} = (-1/z) a u_{N+1}$ and $\langle u_0, J_a^+(z) w \rangle = 0$ since $w \in V_{\lambda, k}$. Then

$$(*) = \sum_{j=1}^{i-1} \sum_{a \in B} \frac{1}{z_i - z_j} \langle u_0, \widehat{\Phi}_{u_1}(z_1), \dots, \widehat{\Phi}_{au_j}(z_j), \dots, \widehat{\Phi}_{au_i}(z_i), \dots, \widehat{\Phi}_{u_N}(z_N) u_{N+1} \rangle,$$

and similarly,

$$(**) = \sum_{j=i+1}^N \sum_{a \in B} \frac{1}{z_i - z_j} \langle u_0, \widehat{\Phi}_{u_1}(z_1), \dots, \widehat{\Phi}_{au_i}(z_i), \dots, \widehat{\Phi}_{au_j}(z_j), \dots, \widehat{\Phi}_{u_N}(z_N) u_{N+1} \rangle.$$

We also get

$$(***) = \sum_{a \in B} \frac{1}{z_i} \langle u_0, \widehat{\Phi}_{u_1}(z_1), \dots, \widehat{\Phi}_{au_i}(z_i), \dots, \widehat{\Phi}_{u_N}(z_N) a u_{N+1} \rangle.$$

This is the action of the Casimir element Ω . □

Remark. For $j > i$, we can write

$$\frac{1}{z_i - z_j} = z_i^{-1} \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} (z_j/z_i)^n.$$

Remark. The usual form of the KZ equations (call this the *symmetric* form) is written as

$$(k + h^\vee) \frac{\partial}{\partial z_i} \psi = \left(\sum_{j=1, j \neq i}^{N+1} \frac{\Omega_{i,j}}{z_i - z_j} \right) \psi$$

for $i = 1, \dots, N+1$. These systems are equivalent: If $\tilde{\psi}(z_1, \dots, z_{N+1})$ is a solution to the above system, then $\psi(z_1, \dots, z_N, 0)$ is a solution to the system in Theorem 18.2 (call this the *non-symmetric* form). Similarly, if $\psi(z_1, \dots, z_N)$ is a solution to the system in Theorem 18.2, then $\tilde{\psi}(z_1, \dots, z_{N+1}) = \psi(z_1 - z_{N+1}, \dots, z_N - z_{N+1})$ is a solution to the above system.

Remark. If $\psi(z_1, \dots, z_{N+1})$ is a solution to the KZ equations, then so is $\psi(z_1 + c, \dots, z_{N+1} + c)$ for constant c . Also notice that for $\lambda_N = 0$, the non-symmetric system turns into the symmetric one.

Remark. If $u_0 \in (V_{\lambda_0, k}[0])^*$ is the lowest weight vector with respect to $\mathfrak{g}$, then

$$\psi(z_1, \dots, z_N) = \langle u_0, \psi(z_1, \dots, z_N) \cdot \rangle$$

(which a priori has values in $V = V_{\mu_1} \otimes \dots \otimes V_{\mu_N} \otimes L_{\lambda_N}^*$) takes values in V^{n-} . If $\lambda_0 = 0$, then this is $\mathfrak{g}$ -invariant, and ψ takes values in $V^{\mathfrak{g}}$.

Theorem 18.3. *The KZ system is consistent, i.e. for all $p, q = 1, \dots, N+1$,*

$$\left[(k + h^\vee) \partial_{z_p} - \sum_{j=1, j \neq p}^{N+1} \frac{\Omega_{p,j}}{z_p - z_j}, (k + h^\vee) \partial_{z_q} - \sum_{j=1, j \neq q}^{N+1} \frac{\Omega_{q,j}}{z_q - z_j} \right] = 0.$$

Proof. We trivially have $\Omega_{p,q} = \Omega_{q,p}$, so

$$[\Omega_{p,q}, \Omega_{p,r} + \Omega_{q,r}] = \left[\sum_a a_p \otimes a_q, \sum_b b_p \otimes b_r + \sum_b b_q \otimes b_r \right] = 0.$$

Expanding this out, we get that

$$0 = \sum_{a, b \in B} (a_q [a_p, b_p] b_r + a_p [a_q, b_q] b_r) = \sum_{b \in B} [\Omega_{p,q}, b_p + b_q] b_r,$$

so that $[\Omega, b \otimes 1 + 1 \otimes b] = 0$. Since $\Omega = \sum_a a \otimes a$, this proves consistency. $\square$

Remark. The above results imply that the KZ equations define a flat connection on a trivial vector bundle V over

$$X_{N+1} = \{(z_1, \dots, z_{N+1}) \in \mathbb{C}^N : z_i \neq z_j\}.$$

We will see later that for any open disk $D \subseteq X_{N+1}$, the space of solutions $\Gamma(D, V_{\text{KZ}})$ is a space of flat sections of V_{KZ} over D . If D is simply connected, then $\Gamma(D, V_{\text{KZ}}) \cong V$ by $\psi \mapsto \psi(p)$. In other words, V_{KZ} is a direct sum of finite dimensional vector bundles (i.e. *local systems*).

Theorem 18.4. *The KZ system is $\mathfrak{g}$ -invariant, meaning that if $x \in \mathfrak{g}$ and ψ is a solution, then $x\psi$ is also a solution.*

Proof. Check as an exercise that $[\sum_{j=1, j \neq p}^{N+1} \Omega_{p,j} / (z_p - z_j), x] = 0$, where $x = \sum_{i=1}^{N+1} x_i$. $\square$

18.2 Analyticity of Correlation Functions

Remark. We change variables from $z_1, \dots, z_N$ to $\zeta_i = z_{i+1}/z_i$ for $i = 1, \dots, N-1$, and $\zeta_N = z_N$. Then the KZ equations become the following system:

$$\zeta_i \frac{\partial}{\partial \zeta_i} \psi = A_i(\zeta_1, \dots, \zeta_{N-1}) \psi.$$

To see this, one can take logarithmic derivatives and then take differences. Here the A_i are holomorphic functions in the region

$$\{|\zeta_j| < 1 : 1 \leq j \leq N\},$$

and we have $[A_i(0), A_j(0)] = 0$ for all i, j .

Proposition 18.1. *Let $A_i(\zeta_1, \dots, \zeta_m)$ for $1 \leq i \leq m$ be $n \times n$ matrix-valued functions holomorphic in the region $R = \{|\zeta_j| < 1 : 1 \leq j \leq m\}$ and such that the differential operators $\zeta_i \partial_{\zeta_i} - A_i$ commute with each other. Assume also that for all i , the eigenvalues of $A_i(0)$ do not differ by a nonzero integer. Then the differential equation*

$$\zeta_i \frac{\partial}{\partial \zeta_i} F = A_i(\zeta_1, \dots, \zeta_m) F, \quad i = 1, \dots, m$$

has a unique $n \times n$ matrix solution of the form

$$F(\zeta_1, \dots, \zeta_m) = F_0(\zeta_1, \dots, \zeta_m) \zeta_1^{A_1(0)} \cdots \zeta_m^{A_m(0)},$$

where F_0 is an $n \times n$ matrix valued function holomorphic in the region R and $F_0(0) = \text{id}$.

Corollary 18.4.1. *In the notation of Proposition 18.1, let f be a vector-valued power series*

$$f(\zeta_1, \dots, \zeta_m) = \zeta_1^{\delta_1} \cdots \zeta_m^{\delta_m} f_0(\zeta_1, \dots, \zeta_m),$$

where $f_0 \in \mathbb{C}^n[[\zeta_1, \dots, \zeta_m]]$ and $\delta_i \in \mathbb{C}$. Then there exists such a vector $v \in \mathbb{C}^n$ such that $f(\zeta_1, \dots, \zeta_m) = F(\zeta_1, \dots, \zeta_m)v$, where F is the fundamental solution from Proposition 18.1, and f converges to an analytic solution in the region R .

Proof. Let $v(\zeta_1, \dots, \zeta_m) = F^{-1}f$, then differentiating gives $\partial_{\zeta_i} v = 0$. □

Theorem 18.5. *The correlation function is absolutely convergent in the region $|z_1| > |z_2| > \cdots > |z_N| > 0$ and defines a regular, multi-valued function in this region.*

Corollary 18.5.1. *For $|z_1| > \cdots > |z_N| > 0$, the product $\widehat{\Phi}_{u_1}(z_1) \cdots \widehat{\Phi}_{u_N}(z_N)$ is a well-defined operator*

$$V_{\lambda_N, k} \longrightarrow \widehat{V}_{\lambda_0, k}$$

(i.e. all matrix elements are converging series).

Corollary 18.5.2. *In the limit $|z_1| \gg \cdots \gg |z_N|$, the correlation function has the following asymptotics:*

$$\psi(z_1, \dots, z_N) \sim z_1^{-\Delta_1} \cdots z_N^{-\Delta_N} v,$$

where $v = \langle u_0, g_1 \cdots g_N \rangle \in V$.

Remark. By Corollary 18.5.2, we can write $\psi = z_1^{-\Delta_1} \cdots z_N^{-\Delta_N} \psi_0$, where

$$\psi_0 = \psi_0(\zeta_1, \dots, \zeta_{N-1}) = \psi_0(z_2/z_1, \dots, z_N/z_{N-1})$$

is analytic in a neighborhood of $\{\zeta_i = 0\}$ and $\psi_0(0) = v$.

Lecture 19

Mar. 18 — KZ Equations, Part 2

19.1 Correlation Functions, Continued

Proposition 19.1. *The correlation functions span the space of solutions of the KZ equations.*

Remark. Let $\xi = (\lambda_0, \dots, \lambda_N; g_1, \dots, g_N; u_0)$, $\lambda_i \in \mathfrak{h}^*$, $g_i \in \text{Hom}_{\mathfrak{g}}(L_{\lambda_i}, L_{\lambda_{i-1}} \otimes V_{\mu_i})$ where $u_0 \in L_{\lambda_0}^*$. Let

$$\Xi = \bigoplus_{\lambda_0, \dots, \lambda_{N-1}} \left(L_{\lambda_0}^* \otimes \bigotimes_{i=1}^N \text{Hom}_{\mathfrak{g}}(L_{\lambda_i}, L_{\lambda_{i-1}} \otimes V_{\mu_i}) \right).$$

The only nonzero terms satisfy $\lambda_i + \mu_i - \lambda_{i-1} \in Q$, and this space has a natural $\mathfrak{g}$ -module structure, and the $\text{Hom}_{\mathfrak{g}}(L_{\lambda_i}, L_{\lambda_{i-1}} \otimes V_{\mu_i})$ are trivial $\mathfrak{g}$ -modules. Each $\xi \in \Xi$ defines a unique correlation function

$$\psi^\xi(z_1, \dots, z_N) \in V = V_{\mu_1} \otimes \dots \otimes V_{\mu_N} \otimes L_{\lambda_N}^*.$$

Theorem 19.1. *Fix λ_N and μ_i for $i = 1, \dots, N$. Let V_{μ_i} be the lowest weight modules satisfying either of the two following conditions:*

1. Generic case: *The weights $\lambda_N, \lambda_N + \mu_N, \dots, \lambda_N + \mu_N + \dots + \mu_1$ are generic and k is generic with respect to each;*
2. Finite-dimensional case: *$\lambda_N, \mu_i \in P^+$, $k \notin \mathbb{Q}$, and the V_{μ_i} are irreducible finite-dimensional modules with lowest weight $-\mu_i$.*

Then the correlation functions span the space of V -valued solutions of the KZ equations in a region D . Moreover, the following map

$$\begin{aligned} \Xi &\longrightarrow \Gamma(D, V_{\text{KZ}}) \\ \xi &\longmapsto \psi^\xi(z_1, \dots, z_N) \end{aligned}$$

is an isomorphism of $\mathfrak{g}$ -modules.

Remark. In Case 1 of Theorem 19.1, the λ_i are generic, and in Case 2, the $\lambda_i \in P^+$.

Lemma 19.1. *Under assumptions (1) or (2) of Theorem 19.1, the map*

$$(\lambda_0, \dots, \lambda_{N-1}; g_1, \dots, g_N; u_0) \longmapsto \langle u_0, g_1 \cdots g_N \cdot \rangle$$

is an isomorphism of $\mathfrak{g}$ -modules.

Proof. Note that $\text{Hom}_{\mathfrak{g}}(L_{\lambda_i}, L_{\lambda_{i-1}} \otimes V_{\mu_i}) \cong \text{Hom}_{\mathfrak{g}}(L_{\lambda_{i-1}}^*, V_{\mu_i} \otimes L_{\lambda_i}^*)$. So it suffices to show that

$$\bigoplus_v \text{Hom}_{\mathfrak{g}}(L_v^*, V_{\mu} \otimes L_{\lambda}^*) \otimes L_v^* \longrightarrow V_{\mu} \otimes L_{\lambda}^*$$

is an isomorphism. This is true if we are in the finite-dimensional case. In general, if λ and $\lambda + \mu$ are generic, the L_v^* being irreducible implies that the above map is injective. Since v is generic, $L_v^* \cong M_v^*$ and $L_{\lambda}^* \cong M_{\lambda}^*$, so $\text{Hom}_{\mathfrak{g}}(L_v^*, V_{\mu} \otimes L_{\lambda}^*) \cong V_{\mu}^{(\lambda-v)}$ (the weight subspace). $\square$

Corollary 19.1.1. *If u_0 is the lowest weight vector, then the correlation functions span solutions with values in $V^{\mathfrak{n}^-}$. Moreover, if u_0 is $\mathfrak{g}$ -invariant, then the correlation functions take values in $V^{\mathfrak{g}}$.*

Remark. We had an identification $\Gamma(D, V_{\text{KZ}}) \cong V$ via $\psi \mapsto \psi(p)$ (i.e. evaluation at p). Now we have

$$\Gamma(D, V_{\text{KZ}}) \cong \Xi \cong V,$$

which is a more sophisticated identification that is not attached to a particular point.

19.2 Trigonometric KZ Equations

Remark. Let $\phi(z_1, \dots, z_N) = \langle u_0, \psi(z_1, \dots, z_N) u_{N+1} \rangle \in V_{\mu_1} \otimes \dots \otimes V_{\mu_N}$. Then

$$\phi \in (V_{\mu_1} \otimes \dots \otimes V_{\mu_N})^{\lambda_N - \lambda_0},$$

and ϕ satisfies the following differential equation

$$(k + h^{\vee}) \frac{\partial}{\partial z_i} \phi = \left(\sum_{j=1}^N \frac{\Omega_{ij}}{z_i - z_j} \right) \phi - \frac{1}{z_i} \sum_e (a_e)_i \langle u_0, \psi(z_1, \dots, z_N) a^{\ell} u_{N+1} \rangle,$$

where a^e, a_e are dual basis elements in $\mathfrak{g}$. For $\alpha \in R_+$, let $e_{\alpha} \in \mathfrak{g}^{\alpha}$, $f_{\alpha} \in \mathfrak{g}^{-\alpha}$ such that $\langle e_{\alpha}, f_{\alpha} \rangle = 1$. Then

$$\Omega = \sum_{\alpha \in R_+} (e_{\alpha} \otimes f_{\alpha} + f_{\alpha} \otimes e_{\alpha}) + \sum_p x_p \otimes x_p,$$

where x_p is the dual basis in $\mathfrak{h}$, and $C = \sum_{\alpha \in R_+} (e_{\alpha} f_{\alpha} + f_{\alpha} e_{\alpha}) + \sum_p x_p^2$. We can rewrite

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_e (a_e)_i \langle u_0, \psi a^{\ell} u_{N+1} \rangle &= \sum_{\alpha \in R_+} (e_{\alpha})_i \langle u_0, \psi f_{\alpha} u_{N+1} \rangle + \sum_p (x_p)_i \langle u_0, \psi \langle x_p, \lambda_N \rangle u_{N+1} \rangle \\ &= \sum_{\alpha \in R_+} (e_{\alpha})_i \sum_{j=1}^N (f_{\alpha})_j \phi + (h_{\lambda_N})_i \phi. \end{aligned}$$

Note that u_0 is $\mathfrak{n}_-$ -invariant. Now ϕ has weight $\lambda_N - \lambda_0$, so

$$\sum_p \sum_{j=1}^N (x_p)_i (x_p)_j \phi = (h_{\lambda_N - \lambda_0})_i \phi.$$

Then we can rewrite

$$\begin{aligned}
\sum_e (a_e)_i \langle u_0, \psi a^\ell u_{N+1} \rangle &= \sum_{j=1}^N \left(\sum_{\alpha \in R_+} (e_\alpha)_i (f_\alpha)_j + \frac{1}{2} \sum_p (x_p)_i (x_p)_j \right) \phi + \frac{1}{2} (h_{\lambda_N} + \lambda_0)_i \phi \\
&= \sum_{j=1}^N \Omega_{i,j}^+ \phi + \frac{1}{2} (h_{\lambda_N + \lambda_0})_i \phi + \left(\sum_{\alpha \in R_+} e_\alpha f_\alpha + \frac{1}{2} \sum_p x_p^2 \right)_i \phi,
\end{aligned}$$

where $\Omega^+ = \sum_{\alpha \in R_+} e_\alpha \otimes f_\alpha + \frac{1}{2} \sum_p x_p \otimes x_p$

$$\Omega^- = \Omega - \Omega^+ = \sum_{\alpha \in R_+} f_\alpha \otimes e_\alpha + \frac{1}{2} \sum_p x_p \otimes x_p.$$

Check as an exercise that $[e_\alpha, f_\alpha] = h_\alpha$ and that

$$\sum e_\alpha f_\alpha + \frac{1}{2} \sum_p x_p^2 = \frac{1}{2} C + h_\rho.$$

Then we have that

$$\begin{aligned}
\sum_\ell (a_\ell)_i \langle u_0, \psi a^\ell u_{N+1} \rangle &= \sum_{\substack{j=1 \\ j \neq i}}^N \Omega_{i,j}^+ \phi + \frac{1}{2} (h_{\lambda_N + \lambda_0 + 2\rho})_i \phi + \frac{1}{2} (C)_i \phi \\
&= \left(\sum_{j=1}^N \Omega_{i,j}^+ + \frac{1}{2} (h_{\lambda_N + \lambda_0 + 2\rho})_i + \frac{1}{2} \langle \mu_i, \mu_i + 2\rho \rangle \right) \phi.
\end{aligned}$$

Thus we can rewrite the KZ equations as

$$(k + h^\vee) z_i \partial_{z_i} \phi = \left(\sum_{\substack{j=1 \\ j \neq i}}^N \frac{z_i \Omega_{i,j}^- + z_j \Omega_{i,j}^+}{z_i - z_j} - \frac{1}{2} (h_{\lambda_N + \lambda_0 + 2\rho})_i - \frac{1}{2} \langle \mu_i, \mu_i + 2\rho \rangle \right) \phi$$

Theorem 19.2. *Let $z_i = e^{z_i}$. Then*

$$(k + h^\vee) \partial_{x_i} \phi = \left(\sum_{\substack{j=1 \\ j \neq i}}^N r_{i,j} (x_i - x_j) - \frac{1}{2} (h_{\lambda_N + \lambda_0 + 2\rho})_i - \langle \mu_i, \mu_i + 2\rho \rangle \right) \phi,$$

where $r(x) = (e^x \Omega^- + \Omega^+) / (e^x - 1)$.

19.3 Factorizable Systems

Remark. The equations we are studying take the form

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial z_i} \phi(z_1, \dots, z_N) = A_i(z_1, \dots, z_N) \phi(z_1, \dots, z_N), \quad \phi \in V, A_i \in \text{End}(V),$$

where $\partial_i A_j \partial_j A_i + [A_i, A_j] = 0$ and the A_i are holomorphic in $D \subseteq \mathbb{C}^N$.

Definition 19.1. We say that such a system is *factorizable* if

1. $V = V_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes V_N$, where the $\{V_i\}$ are $\mathfrak{g}$ -modules,
2. there exists a function $r(z) \in \mathfrak{g} \otimes \mathfrak{g}$ of one complex variable meromorphic in a neighborhood of the origin, and $\kappa \in \mathbb{C}$ such that

$$A_i(z_1, \dots, z_N) = \frac{1}{\kappa} \left(\sum_{j>i} r_{i,j}(z_i - z_j) - \sum_{j<i} r_{j,i}(z_j - z_i) + s_i \right)$$

for $s \in \mathfrak{g}$ such that $[s \otimes 1 + 1 \otimes s, r(z)] = 0$.

Proposition 19.2. *A factorizable system is consistent if*

$$[r_{i,j}(z_i - z_j), r_{j,k}(z_j - z_k)] + [r_{i,k}(z_i - z_k), r_{j,k}(z_j - z_k)] + [r_{i,j}(z_i - z_j), r_{i,k}(z_i - z_k)] = 0.$$

These are called the classical Yang-Baxter equations.

Remark. There are also *quantum Yang-Baxter equations*, which is of the form

$$R_{i,j}(z_i - z_j) = 1 + \hbar r(z_i - z_j) + O(\hbar^2),$$

and one can recover the classical equation from it.

Remark. We can naturally take $V_i \cong U(\mathfrak{g})$ to make a factorizable system, and in this case the condition in Proposition 19.2 is satisfied in $U(\mathfrak{g})^{\otimes 3}$.

Definition 19.2. *Classical r -matrices* are solutions of the classical Yang-Baxter equations which are meromorphic in a neighborhood of the origin with at least one point z where $r(z)$ is nondegenerate.

Definition 19.3. Two classical r -matrices $r(z), \tilde{r}(z)$ are *equivalent* if there is $\phi(x) \in \text{Aut}(\mathfrak{g})$ such that

$$\hat{r}(z_1 - z_2) = (\phi(z_1) \otimes \phi(z_2))r(z_1 - z_2).$$

Theorem 19.3. *A classical r -matrix $r(z)$ extends to a meromorphic function on the complex plane satisfying $r_{1,2}(-z) = -r_{2,1}(z)$. Moreover, they fall into one of the following classes:*

1. Rational: $r(z) = c\Omega/z + P(z)$ for some $P \in \mathfrak{g} \otimes \mathfrak{g} \otimes \mathbb{C}[z]$ and $c \in \mathbb{C}^\times$.
2. Hyperbolic (or trigonometric): $r = f(e^{az})$, where

$$r(z) = \frac{P(e^{az})}{e^{a(n+1)z} - 1} + e^{-anz}Q(e^{az})$$

where P, Q are polynomials and $r(z + 2\pi i/a) = r(z)$.

3. Elliptic: $r(z + n\omega_1) = r(z + n\omega_2) = r(z)$. This case exists only for Type A Lie algebras.